

LawDocs User Manual

Professional operating guide

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Purpose. LawDocs is a staff-facing legal-document assembly system. It combines an approved Word precedent with client information, questionnaire answers, and party details to produce a draft DOCX and, where available, a PDF. It records review, signing, and witness activity; it does not provide legal advice, verify drafting, or send documents to an e-signature provider.

Quick Start by role

Use this section for routine work. Follow the linked full section the first time you perform a task or whenever a warning, failed status, or unfamiliar field appears.

Requesting staff

1. Sign in and check the Dashboard for failed or in-progress work.
2. Open **Clients**, search before creating a duplicate, and confirm the client's current details and contacts.

3. Open **Document Requests** and select **New Document Request**.
4. Select the client and approved precedent. Confirm that client-prefilled answers remain current.
5. Complete every required questionnaire field and party row. Check names, dates, addresses, roles, shares, substitutes, and row order against instructions.
6. Add the firm's case/matter reference and submit once.
7. Open the completed request and review **Submitted Answers**, the DOCX, and the PDF where available. Escalate generation failures with the request ID, exact error, and time.
8. If a correction is required, use **Regenerate** so the original remains in the audit history.

Full guidance: **Sections 5-9**. Never treat **Completed** as legal approval.

Reviewing staff

1. Open **Document Requests → Needs Review**.
2. Select the row and compare the submitted answers, generated title, clauses, parties, formatting, pagination, signature areas, and jurisdiction-specific requirements against approved instructions.
3. If anything is wrong, do not approve. Correct through **Regenerate** or return the precedent/configuration to an authorised operator.
4. If the draft passes the firm's review, select **Approve for Download** and confirm.
5. Download the authorised format and record sending, signing, witnesses, and the executed copy as each event occurs.

Full guidance: **Sections 8-9**. Approval records a human decision; LawDocs does not perform the legal review.

Precedent operators

1. Work on an inactive precedent until configuration and review are complete.
2. Use stable technical names for questionnaire fields and party groups. Configure client mapping only after both sides exist.
3. Upload the private DOCX and resolve every Clause Marker Check error.
4. Configure Structure, Formatting, fields, mapping, and party groups; save before testing.
5. Add paired automated scenarios for each conditional branch and representative one/many/blank cases.
6. Select **Run QA**, open every warning or failure, generate realistic samples, and inspect both DOCX and PDF visually.
7. After authorised review, set the QA baseline and activate the precedent. Run QA again after every change.

Full guidance: **Section 10**. A passing automated test does not certify the legal wording.

Super administrators

1. Maintain least-privilege roles, category restrictions, 2FA policy, and verified staff accounts.

2. Review failed requests, audit events, storage capacity, queue processing, email, and PDF conversion.
3. Confirm backups and restoration procedures outside LawDocs; deletion in the interface is not proof of backup erasure.
4. Test configuration changes in accordance with firm change control and preserve required audit evidence.

Full guidance: **Sections 11-16.**

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1. Before you begin

1.1 What you need

- A LawDocs account and the URL supplied by your administrator (the standard panel path is `/admin`).
- A modern web browser.
- An authenticator app if two-factor authentication (2FA) is enabled for your account.
- Accurate client instructions and authority to handle the personal information entered.

1.2 Roles and screen access

Role	Normal access
panel_user	Dashboard; personal Documents drive; view/create document requests; view/create/update clients and contacts. Cannot delete clients or manage precedents.
operator	All panel-user functions; personal Documents drive; full client management; precedent management; review/approval actions when permitted.
super_admin	Full access, including all users' Documents drives, Audit Log, staff accounts, and System Settings.

An administrator can restrict an operator to selected precedent categories. Menus and buttons the user lacks permission for are hidden. Your screen may therefore contain fewer items than this manual.

1.3 Important safeguards

1. Treat every generated document as a **draft** until reviewed under the firm's procedure.
2. A green **Completed** status means generation succeeded; it does not mean the document is legally correct.
3. **Approve for Download** records human approval but performs no automatic legal check.
4. Minimum-age and witness messages are guidance only. Confirm jurisdiction-specific requirements with a solicitor.
5. **Send for Signature** is a tracking action only. Printing or e-signing occurs outside LawDocs.

2. Screen map and navigation

After sign-in, the left navigation shows the areas available to your role:

Screen	Purpose	Main controls
Dashboard	Workload summary and recent activity	Time-range filter on chart; recent requests
Document Requests	Create, monitor, approve, download, and track documents	New Document Request, filters, row actions, View
Clients	Reusable client and related-contact records	New Client, View, Edit, Delete (permission dependent)
Documents	Private working-file manager for each user	New folder/file, upload, download, rename, copy, move, delete
Precedents	Configure templates and dynamic questionnaires	New Precedent, Edit, Active toggle (operator/admin)
Users	Staff accounts, roles, and category restrictions	New User, Edit, Delete (admin)
Administration → Audit Log	Read-only history of security and record activity	Search, Area/Event/Date filters, View (admin permission)
System Settings	Branding, output defaults, security, and email	Tabs and Save (admin)
Profile menu	Your details, password, avatar, and 2FA	Profile, notifications, Sign out

Common table controls include search, sortable column headings, filters, column visibility, pagination, and per-row actions. A dash (—) means no value or that the item is not applicable.

Annotated screen guides

These maps identify the controls by function. The exact buttons visible depend on role, permission, request status, precedent configuration, and whether PDF conversion is available.

Document Requests list

Area	What it does	Safe use
A • Status tabs	Switches between All, My Requests, In Progress, Needs Review, and Failed; badges show counts	Start with Needs Review or Failed when triaging work
B • Search and filters	Narrows by title/matter, Status, Precedent, Client, and Approval	Clear old session filters if an expected request appears missing

Area	What it does	Safe use
C • New Document Request	Opens the three-step request wizard	Use for one request; avoid double-submitting while generation runs
D • Batch tools	Downloads a precedent-specific CSV template or validates/generates a batch	Review the validation preview before confirming generation
E • Request row	Shows document/matter, client, requester, status, approval, and requested time	Select the row to open its full record
F • Actions menu	Opens, previews, approves, or downloads according to current availability	Missing actions normally indicate status, approval, permission, or PDF availability

Document Request view

Area	What it does	Safe use
A • Request summary	Shows precedent, client, requester, matter reference, status, generation error, and approval	Confirm you opened the correct matter before viewing or downloading
B • Submitted Answers	Preserves the values used for this generation	Compare against current instructions; do not assume client prefill was current
C • Preview/Download	Opens PDF preview or downloads an available approved DOCX/PDF	Visually inspect the final format; preview is not approval
D • Approval	Records an authorised review decision and unlocks downloads when required	Approve only after the firm's complete review procedure
E • Regenerate	Starts a new request using the existing request as its source	Correct the new request and retain the original audit history
F • Signature/Witness areas	Tracks sending, witnesses, signing, and executed-copy upload	Record actual external events; these controls do not send or sign a document

Precedent Edit

Area	What it does	Safe use
A • Configuration tabs	Details, Template File, Structure, Formatting, Questionnaire Fields, Client Mapping, and Party Groups	Save related configuration before testing it

Area	What it does	Safe use
B • Run QA	Validates configuration and executes every active scenario	Open each issue; a count alone is not a diagnosis
C • Secondary actions	Baseline, template download, duplicate, and CSV import tools	Duplicate before substantial experimental changes; imports do not create groups
D • Automated Test Scenarios	Stores repeatable inputs and expected generated output	Use fictional data and paired branch scenarios
E • Quality Assurance Runs	Shows status, issue preview, scenario result, stale state, runner, and time	Select View issues/report for the full evidence
F • Save changes	Persists the editable form configuration	Unsaved changes are not included in a QA run

QA report

Area	Meaning	Response
Validation issues	Configuration or source-template errors/warnings, with severity and code	Correct errors; assess warnings; save and rerun
Scenario results	Each scenario's pass/fail and exact unmet expectation or exception	Correct data, expectation, template, or generator as appropriate
Changes from baseline	Before/after configuration differences since the approved reference	Confirm every change is intended and reviewed
Stale indicator	The precedent/scenarios changed after that run	Do not rely on the old result; run QA again

3. Sign in and account security

Screen: Sign in

1. Open the LawDocs `/admin` address.
2. Enter **Email address** and **Password**.
3. Select **Remember me** only on a private, trusted device.
4. Select **Sign in**.
5. If the account is protected by 2FA, the screen changes to **Two-factor authentication**. Enter either the current six-digit authenticator code or one unused recovery code, then select **Verify**.
6. Use **Back to login** if you need to change the email/password entry.

After five rapid unsuccessful authentication attempts, sign-in is temporarily rate-limited. Wait for the displayed period and try again. Do not repeatedly guess credentials.

Screen: Profile

Open the account menu at the top right and select **Profile**.

1. In **Profile Picture**, upload an image; use the image editor/circular crop if desired.
2. In **Personal Information**, update your name or email.
3. In **Change Password**, enter and confirm a new password. Leave both password fields blank to keep the existing password.
4. Select **Save changes**.

Enable two-factor authentication

If the firm-wide 2FA switch is on:

1. On Profile, select **Enable Two-Factor Authentication**.
2. Scan the QR code with Microsoft Authenticator, Google Authenticator, 1Password, or another TOTP app. The text secret is available for manual entry.
3. Enter the current six-digit code from the app.
4. Confirm the setup.
5. Select **Show Recovery Codes** and store the codes in an approved secure location. Each recovery code is single-use.

Use **Regenerate Recovery Codes** if the set may be exposed; existing codes immediately stop working. Use **Disable Two-Factor Authentication** only in accordance with firm policy. If the administrator disables 2FA firm-wide, setup controls and login challenges are hidden even for previously enrolled accounts.

4. Dashboard

Screen: Dashboard

The welcome panel shows the signed-in user and a summary of today's work. Four statistic cards show:

- **In Progress** — requests in Pending or Processing.
- **Completed** — drafts generated successfully.
- **Failed** — requests with a generation error.
- **Awaiting Review** — completed drafts whose precedents require approval and have not yet been approved.

The **Document Requests** stacked chart groups Pending, Processing, Completed, and Failed items by date. Choose **Last 7 days**, **Last 14 days**, or **Last 30 days**. The **Recent Document Requests** table lists up to eight recent items with precedent, requester, status, and relative time. Dashboard figures refresh approximately every 30 seconds.

Use the Dashboard to identify urgent failed generations and drafts awaiting review; open **Document Requests** for the operational actions.

5. Clients and contacts

Creating a client once allows their details to prefill future requests when a precedent has client mapping configured. Client notes are internal and never inserted into a generated document.

Screen: Clients list

The list shows Name, Email, Phone, number of Contacts, and number of Documents. Search by name/email, sort a column, or use the row actions:

- **View** — open the client and contacts.
- **Edit** — correct the record.
- **Delete** — available only with delete permission. Confirm carefully; related contacts are removed and existing document history may retain a blank client link.

Screen: New Client / Edit Client

1. Select **New Client** (or **Edit** on an existing row).
2. Under **Identity**, enter **Full Name** (required). Add Gender, Date of Birth, Email, and Phone where known. Gender is used for pronoun agreement when mapped to a document.
3. Under **Address**, enter Street, Suburb, Australian State/Territory, and Postcode.
4. Under **Notes**, add internal context only. Do not place wording here that is expected to appear in the document.
5. Select **Create** or **Save changes**.

The document wizard also permits creating a minimal client directly from the Client selector using name, email, and phone. For a complete record, create it from the Clients screen first.

Screen: View Client — Contacts section

Contacts are reusable people associated with the client, such as a spouse, child, accountant, proposed attorney, beneficiary, or guardian.

1. Open a client and locate **Contacts**.
2. Select **Create**.
3. Enter **Full Name** (required) and, where available, Relationship to Client, Gender, Date of Birth, Email, Phone, address, and Notes.
4. Select **Create**.
5. Use the row **Edit** or **Delete** actions to maintain the contact.

During document creation, contacts can be imported into compatible party groups. Matching fields such as name, relationship, gender, email, phone, address, and date of birth are copied; unmatched fields such as an estate share remain for manual completion.

6. Documents file manager

Purpose and access

Select **Documents** in the navigation to open the private file manager. It is a working area for organising files and folders separately from generated Document Request downloads, signed-copy attachments, and precedent templates.

Every normal user is restricted to their own document drive. A super administrator sees **Viewing documents for** and may choose **My files** or another user's name/email to inspect and manage that user's drive. Administrator actions are performed on the selected owner's files, so confirm the selected user before uploading, moving, renaming, or deleting anything.

The screen loads folders and files on demand and displays storage usage against the owner's configured quota. The installation defaults are 2 GB per owner and 100 MB for one upload, but administrators may configure different limits; rely on the values/errors shown by the deployed system.

Understand the file-manager screen

The exact toolbar/context-menu layout can vary with screen width, but the available operations are:

Operation	What it does	Important effect
New folder	Creates an organisational folder in the current location	Duplicate names receive a numbered suffix
New file	Creates a zero-byte placeholder file	It is not an online Word/text editor
Upload	Copies a local file into the current folder	Counts against owner quota and upload-size limit
Download	Downloads the selected stored file	Folders cannot be downloaded as files
Rename	Changes the file/folder's visible name/path	Folder descendants move with the renamed path
Move	Relocates selected items to another folder	A folder cannot be moved into itself/its descendant
Copy	Duplicates selected files/folders and their contents	Copies use additional quota; collisions get numbered names
Delete	Removes selected files/folders	Folder deletion includes descendants and is not a recycle-bin action

Use the toolbar, item context menu, or standard file-manager selection gestures exposed by the screen. Wait for an operation to finish before refreshing or repeating it.

Create a folder structure

1. Open **Documents**.
2. Administrators: confirm **Viewing documents for** is the intended owner.
3. Navigate to the parent location where the folder belongs.
4. Choose the new-folder action.
5. Enter a clear name such as `SUL-2026-014` or `Current Precedents`.
6. Confirm creation, then open the folder.

Recommended structure example:

```
Client Matters
├─ SUL-2026-014
│   └─ Instructions
│   └─ Drafts
│   └─ Executed
```

Use the firm's approved naming convention. Do not include `/` in names; LawDocs removes path separators. If a name already exists, LawDocs creates a unique version such as `Draft (1).docx` rather than overwriting the existing item.

Upload a file

1. Open the destination folder before starting the upload.
2. Choose **Upload**.
3. Select the authorised local file.
4. Retain or enter the intended filename.
5. Confirm the upload and wait for the item to appear.
6. Check the name, folder, file size, and storage-usage indicator.
7. Download and open critical uploads once to confirm the correct file was stored.

If the file exceeds the single-upload limit or would exceed the owner's quota, the upload is rejected. Remove only genuinely redundant data under retention policy or ask an administrator to review capacity. Do not split sensitive documents across unapproved services.

Download a file

1. Locate and select the file—not a folder.
2. Choose **Download**.
3. The browser opens/downloads the file in a new tab or according to browser settings.
4. Store the downloaded copy only in an approved location and remove uncontrolled temporary copies when finished.

Rename, move, or copy

Rename: select the item, choose Rename, enter the complete new name including the correct extension where applicable, and confirm. Renaming `draft.docx` to `draft.pdf` changes only the name, not the file format.

Move: select one or more items, choose Move, select the destination, and confirm. Moving a folder moves its entire subtree. Verify the destination afterwards.

Copy: select items, choose Copy, select the destination, and confirm. Files and all folder descendants are physically duplicated and count against quota. When a target name exists, LawDocs generates a unique numbered name.

Delete files or folders

1. Confirm the selected owner, path, and exact items.
2. Check the firm's retention requirements and whether another record depends on the file.
3. Select **Delete** and confirm.
4. If deleting a folder, understand that every child file/folder is removed too.

Deletion removes both the file-manager record and stored file; this screen has no recycle bin or restore action. Recovery, if possible at all, depends on separately managed backups. File creation, changes, and deletion are recorded in the Audit Log.

File-manager troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Action
Could not load documents	Session, server, storage, or network problem	Refresh once; if repeated, report user, time, and screen error
Upload too large	File exceeds configured maximum	Use an approved smaller file or ask the administrator; do not bypass controls
Storage quota exceeded	Owner's stored file total is at limit	Review retention/capacity with an administrator
Expected file name has (1)	Same name already existed	Compare files and rename deliberately; LawDocs avoided overwriting
Cannot download	Selected item is a folder, missing, or storage unavailable	Select a file; report persistent failures
Administrator sees wrong files	Wrong owner selected	Stop and choose the correct user before making changes

7. Create a document request — complete walkthrough

Screen: Document Requests list

The list is organised for quick triage:

- Use **All**, **My Requests**, **In Progress**, **Needs Review**, or **Failed** at the top. Each tab shows its current request count.
- Search by document title, client, or case/matter reference. Filter by **Status**, **Precedent**, **Client**, or **Approval**; multiple statuses can be selected and filters remain in place during the session.
- The main **Document / Matter** column shows the precedent title with the matter reference (or request number) beneath it. Status and approval are colour-coded, and the Requested value shows relative time; hover it for the exact date and time.
- Select a row to view the request, or open its compact **Actions** menu for **Open request**, **Preview PDF**, approval, and available DOCX/PDF downloads. Only actions currently available for that request are shown.
- **Case Reference** is hidden by default because it is already shown under the document title. Use the table column control to display it as a separate column when needed.
- Select **New Document Request** for one request. Use **Batch tools** for the CSV template and batch-generation workflow.

Step 1 of 3: Precedent

1. In **Client (optional)**, search for and select an existing client. This enables mapped prefilling and contact imports. You can leave it blank for an ad hoc matter.
2. If the client is missing, use the create option in the selector for a minimal record, or cancel and create the full client from **Clients**.
3. In **Precedent**, search for and choose the required document template. Only active precedents available to your role appear.
4. Confirm the title and, through firm procedure, the correct jurisdiction/document type. Each jurisdiction is maintained as a separate precedent.
5. Select **Next**.

Changing the precedent resets its dynamic answers and party groups before applying any configured client prefill. Recheck every field after changing either selector.

How the selected precedent controls the request

The Precedent selection is not merely a file choice. It controls four connected parts of the request:

Precedent configuration	What staff see or receive
Questionnaire Fields	The individual inputs on the Details step, such as Principal's Full Name or Enduring Power of Attorney?

Precedent configuration	What staff see or receive
Client Mapping	Which questionnaire inputs are prefilled from the selected client
Party Groups	Repeatable rows such as Beneficiaries, Attorneys, or Guardians, including minimum rows and share validation
Generator + Template File	The clauses, conditional wording, repeated party wording, formatting, and final document title

If an expected field or party group is missing from Details, stop. Do not force the information into an unrelated field. The precedent configuration must be corrected by an authorised operator before a reliable document can be generated.

Step 2 of 3: Details

The fields are generated from the selected precedent, so this screen varies. Required fields are marked. Inputs can be text, multi-line text, number, date, Yes/No, or a fixed-choice list.

1. Review all client-prefilled values against current instructions. Prefill is editable and is not proof that the information remains current.
2. Complete each questionnaire field. Enter names exactly as they should appear in the legal document.
3. For each party group, either:
 - select people in **Import into [Group] from [Client]'s Contacts**, then complete any missing values; or
 - select **Add [Group]** and enter the party manually.
4. Expand/collapse rows as needed and drag to reorder them. Order can affect the generated document.
5. For beneficiary groups, make all shares total exactly **100%**. Submission is rejected otherwise.
6. If **Per stirpes substitution** appears, enable it only where the instructions require the person's share to pass to their surviving children if that person does not survive.
7. If **Specific Substitute** appears, choose the intended replacement from another row. Avoid duplicate party names because substitute matching uses the displayed primary name.
8. Select **Next**.

Worked request example: Power of Attorney

Assume client **Amara Osei** is selected with a Power of Attorney precedent whose client mapping connects `Client name → principal_name` and `Client DOB → principal_dob`.

1. The Details screen prefills Principal's Full Name as **Amara Osei** and the saved date of birth. Confirm both against current identification.
2. Enter Principal's Address as **5 Bridge Road, Manly NSW 2095**.

3. Set **Enduring Power of Attorney?** to Yes if the approved instructions require the enduring clause.
4. Set **Attorneys must act jointly?** to No if the attorneys may act jointly and severally.
5. Under Attorneys, add **Kwame Osei**, his address, and relationship **Son**.
6. Add **Linda Park**, her address, and relationship **Friend**.
7. Preserve the intended attorney order and continue to Review.

With those values, a correctly configured template can repeat the appointment sentence once for each attorney, include the enduring notice, and choose the jointly-and-severally wording. The request screen supplies data; it does not decide whether those instructions are legally suitable.

Worked request example: Will beneficiary validation

For two beneficiaries, a valid setup could be:

Order	Name	Share	Gender	Per stirpes
1	David Sullivan	60	Male	Yes
2	Emily Sullivan	40	Female	No

The total is 100%, so validation passes. The beneficiary clause repeats twice. The per-stirpes subclause appears only below David's gift because his toggle is Yes. Entries of 60% and 30%, blank shares, or an accidental duplicate row prevent submission or produce incorrect instructions and must be corrected.

Request-entry quality checks

Before leaving Details, confirm:

- names, accents, initials, and entity suffixes are exactly as intended;
- address text is complete and formatted for insertion into the document;
- all Yes/No answers match the signed instructions;
- no imported contact was added twice;
- row order reflects appointment/gift priority;
- each required minimum party count is satisfied;
- percentage shares total 100 where enforced;
- gender selections are correct because generators may use them for pronouns;
- optional fields are intentionally blank, not accidentally overlooked.

Included starter precedents and their data

The repository provides these sample NSW precedents. A live installation may have different or additional active precedents.

Last Will and Testament captures testator name, optional date of birth, street, suburb/city, state wording, gender, executor name/gender, optional alternate executor name/gender, and one or

more beneficiaries. Each beneficiary has name, estate share, gender, and optional per-stirpes treatment. Shares must total 100%.

Power of Attorney captures principal name, optional date of birth, address, whether the power is enduring, whether multiple attorneys act jointly, and one or more attorneys with name, address, and relationship.

Enduring Guardianship captures principal name, optional date of birth, address, whether multiple guardians act jointly, and one or more guardians with name, address, and relationship.

These starter templates are explicitly demo content and require solicitor review before real-client use.

Step 3 of 3: Review

1. Enter **Case / Matter Reference** if your filing convention uses one. It is optional but strongly recommended for retrieval.
2. Read any age warning. An entered testator/principal date of birth below the ordinary minimum age produces a soft warning; it does not block submission because exceptions may exist.
3. Return to **Details** and perform a final comparison with signed-off client instructions.
4. Before submitting, optionally select **Preview Document (.docx)** or **Preview Document (PDF)** at the top of the page — these render the wizard's current answers exactly as entered, including a still-incomplete form, with no document request created and nothing saved. The PDF version opens directly in a new browser tab; the DOCX version downloads (Word files cannot be shown inline in a browser). Use this to catch conditional-wording or repeated-row problems before committing.
5. Select **Create** / submit the wizard once. Generation normally takes about 10–30 seconds when synchronous processing is configured.

The new request stores a snapshot of the precedent title, jurisdiction, answers, parties, requester, and time. It then moves through these statuses:

Status	Meaning	User response
Pending	Accepted but not yet started	Wait; if it remains pending unusually long, ask an administrator to check the queue worker.
Processing	Draft is being assembled	Wait and refresh later; do not submit duplicates.
Completed	DOCX was generated	Review/approve if required, then download.
Failed	Generation could not finish	Open View, read Error, correct the precedent/input with an authorised person, then Regenerate.

The notification bell is polled about every 30 seconds for completion/failure notifications.

What happens after submission

Submission saves the questionnaire answers separately from party rows. The generator then reads the selected precedent and combines:

1. generator-produced paragraphs, such as the Will executor appointment chain;
2. verbatim tagged clauses from the uploaded DOCX;
3. conditional blocks selected by Yes/No answers or computed flags;
4. repeated blocks expanded once per stored party row; and
5. placeholders replaced with request values.

This explains why a request can be entered correctly but still fail when the precedent contains an unknown placeholder, a missing required clause, or a mismatched group key. Open the failed request and preserve its exact Error message for the precedent administrator.

8. Review, approval, and download

Screen: Document Request view

Open **View** from the list. The **Request** section displays precedent, client, requester, case reference, generation status/error, generated title/time, approval status, and approver. **Submitted Answers** preserves the values used for generation.

Use the following review procedure:

1. Compare **Submitted Answers** with source instructions.
2. Select **Preview (PDF)** to read the completed draft in a new browser tab. Unlike Download, this is available as soon as generation completes — before approval — specifically so a reviewer can read the actual wording before deciding whether to approve it, not just trust it blind. It opens inline and downloads nothing.
3. A user with approval permission selects **Approve for Download** (or **Approve** on the list) and confirms. This records the approver and timestamp. Only after this step do the Download buttons appear for a review-required precedent.
4. Select **Download .docx** for the editable Word draft.
5. Select **Download PDF** for a PDF rendition when the server's office converter is available. If the button is absent, download DOCX and follow the firm's approved conversion method.

Download is available only when generation is Completed and either review is not required or approval has been recorded. A direct download link cannot bypass this rule.

Regenerate an existing request

Use **Regenerate** when a corrected version is required.

1. Open the existing request and select **Regenerate**.
2. A new three-step request is opened with the existing client, precedent, answers, parties, and case reference prefilled where still valid.
3. Verify all values—especially if the precedent has since changed.
4. Correct the required data and submit.
5. Treat the result as a new request with its own generation and approval history. The original remains available as an audit record.

9. Signature and witness tracking

The **Signing** section appears after the request is ready for download. Its status is **Not sent**, **Sent for signature**, or **Signed**.

Record sending

1. Complete approval/download checks.

2. Send the document for wet signature or external e-signature using the firm's normal process.
3. In LawDocs select **Send for Signature** and confirm. This only saves the sent timestamp; it does not transmit the document.

Record witnesses

1. On the request view, locate the **Witnesses** table.
2. Select **Create**.
3. Enter Full Name (required), Address, and Occupation.
4. Save. Add further witnesses as required.
5. Compare the recorded count with the displayed jurisdiction guidance and confirm the actual legal requirement with a solicitor.

LawDocs prevents a person already recorded as a document party from being entered as a witness. Use **Edit** or **Delete** to correct witness records.

Mark signed and attach the executed copy

1. Once signing is confirmed, select **Mark as Signed**.
2. Optionally upload the wet-signed scan or externally e-signed copy under **Executed Document**.
3. Confirm. The signed timestamp is recorded.
4. If a file was attached, **Download Signed Copy** becomes available.

10. Precedent management (operator/administrator)

Precedent changes affect future generations and require controlled testing and solicitor approval. Existing request snapshots remain historical records.

Screen: Precedents list

The list includes Title, Category, Jurisdiction, Active, Generator, questionnaire-field count, and creation date. Search/filter as available. The **Active** switch controls whether staff can select the precedent in a new request.

Screen: New/Edit Precedent — Details tab

1. Enter Title, Category, and Jurisdiction.
2. Choose the **Document Generator** that matches the document type. A developer must add new generator types.
3. Add a clear Description.
4. Set **Active** only after validation and approval.
5. Leave **Requires review before download** on unless the firm has formally approved unreviewed release.

Template File tab

The Template File is the most technically sensitive part of precedent setup. Build and test it in a non-production workflow. Only `.docx` files are accepted.

First understand what this Word file is—and is not

For the four included generators, LawDocs does **not** use the uploaded Word file as one complete mail-merge document. It reads only the content placed between recognised `[[CLAUSE:...]]` and `[/CLAUSE]]` boundaries. The generator then places those named clause contents into a newly generated document together with headings and paragraphs produced by the application.

This has four important consequences for a beginner:

1. Ordinary text typed outside a named clause is not automatically included in the final document.
2. A clause name is a connection point between Word and the selected generator. It is not a heading visible to the client.
3. The generator must request that exact clause name. A correctly spelled but unused clause will still not appear.
4. The Word file supplies approved clause wording and formatting; the Questionnaire Fields and Party Groups supply variable data.

Think of the process as:

Questionnaire answers + Party rows + Named Word clauses



Selected generator



New generated document

Do not begin in Word until these items are ready

Before preparing the DOCX, complete or confirm:

1. The solicitor-approved clause wording for the correct jurisdiction.
2. The correct **Document Generator** on the Details tab.
3. The complete **Questionnaire Fields** list and exact field names.
4. The complete **Party Groups** list, group keys, and row field names.
5. Which passages are always included, conditional, or repeated.
6. A test plan containing realistic but non-client data.

If any technical name changes after the DOCX is built, every reference to that name must also change.

Exact clause names required by the included generators

Use this table only for the included generator selected on the Details tab. Custom generators may require different names.

Selected generator	Clause markers required by the generator	Allowed repeat group	Allowed IF conditions
Will	revocation, beneficiaries_clause, executor_powers	beneficiaries	beneficiary.per_stirpes inside the beneficiary repeat
Power of Attorney	appointment_clause, enduring_notice, general_powers, revocation	attorneys	attorneys_act_jointly, is_enduring
Enduring Guardianship	appointment_clause, guardian_functions, revocation	guardians	guardians_act_jointly

Selected generator	Clause markers required by the generator	Allowed repeat group	Allowed IF conditions
Costs Agreement	the_work, our_fees, disbursements, billing_units_and_increases, fees_estimate, gst, interest, completion_estimate, billing_arrangements, itemised_bills, your_rights, costs_recovery_and_disputes, progress_reports, substantial_change, trust_money, authority_to_receive_moneys, costs_in_proceedings, engaging_another_practitioner, document_retention, company_signatories, legal_aid, suspension, termination, governing_law, email_communication, severability	work_items	estimate_completion_gst, estimate_fees_expenses_gst

For example, when the Power of Attorney generator runs, it specifically asks for `appointment_clause`. Calling that block `attorney_appointment`, `appointment`, or `Appointment Clause` will not work.

Every generator also accepts one further, optional clause not listed above: `front_matter`. All four generators otherwise open the document with a fixed, built-in introductory paragraph (for example, the Will’s “This is the last will and testament of...” sentence, or the Costs Agreement’s BETWEEN/AND/DATED lines and offer/acceptance wording). Tagging `[[CLAUSE:front_matter]]` in the DOCX replaces that built-in wording entirely with the precedent author’s own — leave it out to keep the built-in default. See “Example 7: optional front matter override” below.

How to type a marker correctly in Microsoft Word

Follow these literal steps for every marker line:

1. Open the approved DOCX in Microsoft Word and turn on **Home → ¶ Show/Hide**. This makes paragraph boundaries visible.
2. Click at the start of a new, empty paragraph.
3. Type the marker using normal keyboard characters. For example: `[[CLAUSE:revocation]]`.

4. Press **Enter once**. Do not press Shift+Enter; Shift+Enter creates a line break inside the same paragraph.
5. Type or paste the approved clause wording in the following paragraph(s).
6. At the end of the clause, press Enter to make another empty paragraph.
7. Type `[[/CLAUSE]]` and press Enter.
8. Leave marker paragraphs as plain body paragraphs. Do not make them list items, headers, footers, text boxes, table cells, comments, or tracked-deletion text.
9. Save using **File → Save As → Word Document (.docx)**. Do not save as `.doc`, PDF, RTF, or an online-document shortcut.

In Word with ¶ displayed, a correct three-paragraph clause conceptually looks like this:

```
[[CLAUSE:revocation]]¶
I revoke all prior powers of attorney made by me.¶
[[/CLAUSE]]¶
```

The ¶ symbols are displayed by Word; do not type them. The visible legal wording may contain multiple paragraphs or supported list items between the two boundary markers.

Character-by-character marker rules

- Use two ordinary opening square brackets `[[` and two closing square brackets `]]`.
- Use a colon `:` after `CLAUSE`, `IF`, or `REPEAT`—not a semicolon or hyphen.
- Closing markers contain a forward slash `/`: `[[/CLAUSE]]`, `[[/IF]]`, `[[/REPEAT]]`.
- Clause names begin with a letter and use letters, digits, and underscores only. Use `general_powers`, not `general powers` or `general-powers`.
- Group keys and aliases use letters, digits, and underscores. Copy the group key from Party Groups rather than retyping from memory.
- `AS` in a repeat is uppercase in the documented form: `[[REPEAT:attorneys AS attorney]]`.
- Placeholder braces are doubled: `{{answers.principal_name}}`. A single `{...}` is ordinary text and will not be replaced.
- Technical names are case-sensitive in practice. Always copy them exactly.
- Smart quotation marks are not part of any marker. Do not wrap a marker in quotes.
- Do not add a full stop after a boundary marker: `[[/CLAUSE]].` is wrong.
- Leading/trailing spaces are trimmed, but relying on them makes review harder. Keep marker lines clean.

Correct and incorrect Word paragraphs

Correct	Incorrect	Why incorrect
<code>[[CLAUSE:revocation]]</code>	Revocation <code>[[CLAUSE:revocation]]</code>	Boundary marker is not the entire paragraph
<code>[[/CLAUSE]]</code>	<code>[[/Clause]]</code>	Wrong capitalisation/text

Correct	Incorrect	Why incorrect
<code>[[IF:is_enduring]]</code>	<code>[[IF is_enduring]]</code>	Missing colon
<code>[[/IF]]</code>	<code>[[ENDIF]]</code>	Unsupported closing syntax
<code>[[REPEAT:attorneys AS attorney]]</code>	<code>[[REPEAT:attorney AS attorneys]]</code>	Group and alias reversed/wrong group key
<code>{{attorney.address}}</code>	<code>{{attorneys.address}}</code>	Placeholder must use the alias declared after AS
<code>{{answers.principal_name}}</code>	<code>{{answers.Principal's Full Name}}</code>	Must use field name, not screen label
Marker on its own normal paragraph	Marker embedded in a bullet paragraph	Control marker must occupy a clean paragraph

What the words “group” and “alias” mean

In `[[REPEAT:attorneys AS attorney]]`:

- `attorneys` is the Party Group key. It represents the whole list of attorney rows saved in the request.
- `attorney` is a temporary singular name for the one row currently being produced.
- `{{attorney.name}}` reads the `name` field from that current row.
- After `[[/REPEAT]]`, the `attorney` alias no longer exists.

The alias does not need to match the label shown to staff, but a clear singular alias prevents mistakes: `beneficiaries AS beneficiary`, `attorneys AS attorney`, and `guardians AS guardian`.

What can be placed inside what

Use this nesting order:

```

CLAUSE
├─ ordinary paragraphs/list items/placeholders
├─ IF ... optional ELSE ... /IF
└─ REPEAT
    ├─ row placeholders using its alias
    └─ IF for a row-specific flag
        /IF
    /REPEAT
/CLAUSE

```

`IF` and `REPEAT` controls must be inside a named `CLAUSE`. An `IF` may be placed inside a `REPEAT`, as in the beneficiary per-stirpes example. Close inner controls before outer controls. Never cross them.

Correct closing order:

```
[[CLAUSE:beneficiaries_clause]]
[[REPEAT:beneficiaries AS beneficiary]]
[[IF:beneficiary.per_stirpes]]
Conditional wording here.
[[/IF]]
[[/REPEAT]]
[[/CLAUSE]]
```

Incorrect closing order:

```
[[CLAUSE:beneficiaries_clause]]
[[REPEAT:beneficiaries AS beneficiary]]
[[IF:beneficiary.per_stirpes]]
Conditional wording here.
[[/REPEAT]]
[[/IF]]
[[/CLAUSE]]
```

Safe formatting rules inside the clause

- Apply bold, italic, underline, and ordinary paragraph formatting to the legal wording, not to the marker lines.
- Use genuine Word numbered/bulleted lists when numbering must be preserved; do not simulate lists with spaces and manually typed numbers unless that is the approved design.
- Multi-level lists are supported within clauses, including repeated/conditional list items.
- Keep control markers out of tables. A table inside a marked clause is rejected by the current parser.
- Avoid text boxes, shapes, floating objects, headers, and footers for variable clause content; extracted preview may omit them.
- Accept/reject tracked changes and remove unresolved comments before upload. This reduces the risk of unintended or deleted wording entering the controlled template.
- Do not split a placeholder across differently formatted Word runs. Type/paste the complete token in one action and apply formatting to the entire token or containing sentence.
- Preserve an untouched approved master file outside LawDocs under the firm's document-control procedure.

The four pieces of template syntax

Syntax	Purpose	Example
[[CLAUSE:name]] ... [[/CLAUSE]]	Names a clause that the selected generator can retrieve	[[CLAUSE:revocation]]
{{answers.field}}	Inserts a questionnaire answer	{{answers.principal_name}}
[[IF:flag]] ... [[ELSE]] ... [[/IF]]	Includes one branch according to a supported condition	[[IF:is_enduring]]

Syntax	Purpose	Example
<code>[[REPEAT:group AS alias]] ... [[/REPEAT]]</code>	Repeats content once for each party row	<code>[[REPEAT:attorneys AS attorney]]</code>

Every opening/closing control marker must occupy its own Word paragraph—the complete paragraph text, with no bullet, prefix, suffix, or comment. Write `[[CLAUSE:revocation]]`, not `Clause: [[CLAUSE:revocation]]`. Clause names cannot be duplicated or nested. Tables inside marked clauses are not supported. Normal text, bold styling, paragraphs, and multi-level Word lists inside supported clauses are preserved.

Example 1: simple named clause

Enter the following as three separate Word paragraphs:

```
[[CLAUSE:revocation]]
I revoke all prior powers of attorney made by me.
[[/CLAUSE]]
```

The marker lines do not appear in the generated document. The generator requests the clause named `revocation` and inserts the middle paragraph with its Word formatting. The clause name must be one expected by that generator; merely inventing a new name does not make the generator use it.

Example 2: questionnaire placeholder

If Questionnaire Fields contains `principal_name` and `principal_address`, a clause can contain:

```
This Power of Attorney is made by {{answers.principal_name}} of
{{answers.principal_address}}.
```

For a request containing **Amara Osei** and **5 Bridge Road, Manly NSW 2095**, the generated text becomes:

```
This Power of Attorney is made by Amara Osei of 5 Bridge Road, Manly NSW 2095.
```

The spelling after `answers.` must exactly match the field name—not its staff-facing label. `{{answers.Principal Name}}` and `{{principal_name}}` are invalid. An unresolved placeholder fails generation rather than silently leaving a blank token.

Example 3: conditional wording with ELSE

For the Power of Attorney generator, the supported `attorneys_act_jointly` flag can select one of two paragraphs:

```
[[IF:attorneys_act_jointly]]
My Attorneys must act jointly in the exercise of this power.
[[ELSE]]
My Attorneys may act jointly and severally in the exercise of this power.
[[/IF]]
```

If the request answer is Yes, only the first paragraph is generated. If No, only the ELSE paragraph is generated. Without an `[[ELSE]]`, a false condition produces no content. Use only flags listed in **Available flags & party groups for this generator**; an unknown condition fails validation/generation.

Example 4: optional enduring clause

```
[[CLAUSE:enduring_notice]]
[[IF:is_enduring]]
This Power of Attorney continues to have effect even if I lose capacity.
[[/IF]]
[[/CLAUSE]]
```

When **Enduring Power of Attorney?** is Yes, the sentence is included. When No, the named clause expands to no visible content. The legal wording remains the precedent author's responsibility.

Example 5: repeat attorney rows

The Party Groups tab defines group key `attorneys` with fields `name`, `address`, and `relationship`. The template may contain:

```
[[CLAUSE:appointment_clause]]
[[REPEAT:attorneys AS attorney]]
I appoint {{attorney.name}} of {{attorney.address}} to be my Attorney.
[[/REPEAT]]
[[/CLAUSE]]
```

For two party rows—Kwame Osei and Linda Park—the appointment sentence is produced twice in the same order as the request rows. `attorneys` must exactly match the Party Group key and a group supported by the generator. `attorney` is the local alias used only inside this repeat. A placeholder such as `{{attorney.name}}` outside its repeat is out of scope and fails generation.

Example 6: nested repeat and conditional beneficiary wording

For a `beneficiaries` group with fields `name`, `share`, and the enabled per-stirpes option:

```

[[CLAUSE:beneficiaries_clause]]
[[REPEAT:beneficiaries AS beneficiary]]
I give {{beneficiary.share}}% of my estate to {{beneficiary.name}}.
[[IF:beneficiary.per_stirpes]]
If {{beneficiary.name}} does not survive me, that share passes to their surviving children
in equal shares.
[[/IF]]
[[/REPEAT]]
[[/CLAUSE]]

```

With David at 60%/per-stirpes Yes and Emily at 40%/per-stirpes No, both gift sentences are produced, but the survival paragraph appears only for David. The application supports this nesting. The exact legal language above is an explanatory example, not approved precedent wording.

Example 7: optional front matter override

Every generator opens the document with a fixed, built-in introductory paragraph unless the precedent tags its own `front_matter` clause. For the Will generator:

```

[[CLAUSE:front_matter]]
This is the last will and testament of {{answers.testator_name}} of
{{answers.testator_street}}, {{answers.testator_suburb}} in the
{{answers.testator_state}}.
[[/CLAUSE]]

```

If `front_matter` is present, the generator uses only this wording in place of its built-in sentence — the rest of the document (Structure sections, clauses) is unaffected. If `front_matter` is absent, nothing changes from the previous behaviour. This is the one place besides an ordinary named clause where a firm can put its own approved opening wording under full document-control, without a developer.

For the Costs Agreement generator specifically, `front_matter` also has access to `{{answers.agreement_date}}` — today's date, formatted as it would appear in the built-in BETWEEN/AND/DATED lines. This value is generated automatically each time the document is produced; it is not a Questionnaire Field and does not need to be added to Questionnaire Fields.

Configuration-to-template matching checklist

Before upload, cross-check every technical identifier:

In configuration	Must match in DOCX
Questionnaire field <code>principal_name</code>	<code>{{answers.principal_name}}</code>
Party Group key <code>attorneys</code>	<code>[[REPEAT:attorneys AS attorney]]</code>
Party field <code>address</code>	<code>{{attorney.address}}</code> inside that repeat

In configuration	Must match in DOCX
Per-stirpes support enabled	[[IF:beneficiary.per_stirpes]] where supported
Generator's required clause <code>appointment_clause</code>	[[CLAUSE:appointment_clause]] exactly once

Upload and validation procedure

1. On **Details**, select the correct Document Generator first.
2. Return to **Template File** and read **Available flags & party groups for this generator**. Treat it as the allowed vocabulary for IF and REPEAT markers.
3. Upload the DOCX.
4. Read **Clause Marker Check**. Correct every unclosed, duplicate, nested, stray, unknown flag/group/field, or unsupported-structure message; then upload the corrected version.
5. Inspect **Extracted Text (preview)**. It is a flattened reference view (# headings and - list items), not an exact visual preview. Empty/missing text can indicate unsupported tables or text boxes.
6. Save the precedent as inactive while testing.
7. Create representative requests covering every branch: Yes and No conditions, one and multiple party rows, optional fields blank and filled, per-stirpes on/off, and boundary share values.
8. Review both generated DOCX and PDF for wording, ordering, numbering, formatting, missing content, and unresolved tokens.
9. Obtain the required solicitor/firm approval, then activate the precedent.

Beginner walkthrough: build a Power of Attorney DOCX from a blank file

This walkthrough is for learning the mechanics. Replace every example sentence with approved wording before production.

Part A — configure LawDocs first

1. Create/edit the precedent and select **Power of Attorney** as Document Generator.
2. On Questionnaire Fields, confirm these exact field names: `principal_name`, `principal_address`, `is_enduring`, and `attorneys_act_jointly`. The included setup also uses optional `principal_dob`.
3. On Party Groups, create key `attorneys` with row fields `name`, `address`, and `relationship`; set minimum rows to 1.
4. Save the precedent with **Active off**.

Part B — prepare the DOCX

1. Open a blank Word document and enable ¶ Show/Hide.
2. Type each line below as its own paragraph. After every marker line, press Enter—not Shift+Enter.


```

[[CLAUSE:appointment_clause]]
[[REPEAT:attorneys AS attorney]]
I appoint {{attorney.name}} of {{attorney.address}} to be my Attorney.
[[/REPEAT]]
[[IF:attorneys_act_jointly]]
My Attorneys must act jointly in the exercise of this power.
[[ELSE]]
My Attorneys may act jointly and severally in the exercise of this power.
[[/IF]]
[[/CLAUSE]]

[[CLAUSE:enduring_notice]]
[[IF:is_enduring]]
This Power of Attorney is intended to continue if I lose capacity.
[[/IF]]
[[/CLAUSE]]

[[CLAUSE:general_powers]]
Approved general powers wording goes here.
[[/CLAUSE]]

[[CLAUSE:revocation]]
Approved revocation wording goes here.
[[/CLAUSE]]

```

1. Use blank ordinary paragraphs between clauses only for editing readability; do not place an extra marker outside a clause.
2. Apply the approved formatting to the legal-content paragraphs.
3. Save as `Power-of-Attorney-NSW-v1.docx`. A controlled filename is helpful, although LawDocs uses the stored precedent title/record rather than the filename to select it.

Part C — upload and perform the first check

1. In LawDocs, open the Template File tab and upload the DOCX.
2. Wait for the upload/save operation to complete.
3. If **Clause Marker Check** contains any text, treat it as a failed check. Do not activate the precedent.
4. In **Extracted Text**, confirm all four clause names' content is represented and the legal paragraphs are in the expected order.
5. If content is missing, simplify the Word structure and remove text boxes/tables before uploading a corrected file.

Part D — test every branch

Create at least these four requests with fictional data:

Test	Attorneys	Enduring?	Act jointly?	Expected result
1	One	Yes	Yes	One appointment; enduring paragraph included; joint wording included
2	One	No	No	One appointment; enduring paragraph absent; joint-and-several wording included
3	Two	Yes	No	Two appointments in entered order; enduring paragraph; joint-and-several wording
4	Two	No	Yes	Two appointments; no enduring paragraph; joint wording

For every generated document, inspect the DOCX—not only the extracted preview. Search the output for `[[ , ]]`, `{{ , }}`; none should remain. Check headings, page breaks, numbering, punctuation, singular/plural wording, blank sections, and PDF conversion.

How to respond to common Clause Marker Check messages

Message meaning	Typical mistake	Correction
Clause never closed	<code>[[CLAUSE: ...]]</code> exists but no later <code>[/CLAUSE]</code>	Add the closing marker on its own paragraph
Closing marker has no matching opener	Extra <code>[/CLAUSE]</code> , <code>[/IF]</code> , or <code>[/REPEAT]</code>	Remove it or add the correct opener in the proper order
Duplicate clause	Same clause name used twice	Combine the content into one named clause; each name appears once
Nested clause markers	A new <code>CLAUSE</code> begins before the previous <code>CLAUSE</code> closes	Close the first clause; clauses cannot contain clauses
Unknown flag	IF name is misspelled or unsupported by the generator	Copy an allowed flag from the on-screen reference

Message meaning	Typical mistake	Correction
Unknown party group	REPEAT key differs from Party Groups/generator	Copy the exact group key, such as attorneys
Namespace/alias not in scope	Placeholder uses attorney outside its repeat or uses a different alias	Move it inside the repeat or correct the alias
Unknown field	Placeholder field is not defined for answers/group rows	Correct the name or add/configure the intended field consistently
Tables not supported inside clauses	Legal content inside a Word table between clause markers	Redesign it as supported paragraphs/lists or obtain a developer-supported solution

If upload passes but generation still fails

1. Open the failed Document Request and copy the exact **Error** text.
2. Do not keep resubmitting the same request.
3. Confirm the request contains all required answers and minimum party rows.
4. Confirm the precedent still uses the intended generator and uploaded file.
5. Compare the error's clause/placeholder name with Questionnaire Fields, Party Groups, and the DOCX.
6. Correct the inactive precedent, re-upload it, and repeat the complete test matrix.
7. Use **Regenerate** from the original request only after the configuration is corrected; verify all copied values before submission.

Final activation sign-off checklist

Do not switch **Active** on until each item is Yes:

- correct document category and jurisdiction;
- correct generator selected;
- exact required clause names present once each;
- all markers use their own paragraphs and close in the correct order;
- Clause Marker Check is empty;
- extracted preview contains the expected wording;
- all questionnaire placeholders match configured field names;
- all repeat groups/aliases/row fields match configuration;
- every Yes/No and row-count test has been generated;
- DOCX formatting and PDF conversion have been visually reviewed;
- no marker tokens or sample data remain in output;
- solicitor/authorised reviewer has approved the legal wording;
- controlled version/source and approval evidence have been retained.

Do not activate a precedent with a marker error, unreliable extraction, untested conditional branch, or unreviewed output.

Structure tab

The Structure tab controls which sections a generated document contains, their order, their headings, and whether each one is shown — without a developer touching code. Leave it empty to use the selected generator’s built-in default section list, unchanged.

Add or reorder a section step by step

1. Select **Add section**.
2. Enter **Section heading** — the visible text, for example `Beneficiaries`. Do not type a number; numbering is automatic and always rennumbers sequentially, skipping any section that is hidden by its condition.
3. Choose **Content source**:
 - **Clause tag (from the .docx)** — the normal case. Enter the exact `[[CLAUSE:...]]` tag name in **Clause tag**.
 - **Computed block (from the generator)** — only for the small number of sections a generator computes in code rather than reading from a clause tag (for example, the Will’s executor-appointment paragraph). Enter the exact key shown under **Computed blocks** in the Template File tab’s on-screen reference.
4. Optionally enter **Show only if** using the same `[[IF:...]]`-style flag name grammar as inside the DOCX, to hide the section entirely when the condition is false. Leave blank to always show it.
5. Drag sections into the required order. Collapse each item once configured.
6. Save the precedent. **Clause Marker Check** re-validates every Structure entry against the uploaded DOCX and the selected generator — an unknown tag, unknown computed-block key, or unknown condition flag is reported the same way as a DOCX marker error.
7. Generate a test request and confirm the section order, headings, numbering, and visibility match expectations.

What Structure can and cannot do

- It can add, remove, reorder, rename (via heading text), and conditionally show/hide whole sections, for any generator — the four specialist generators and the no-code Template generator alike.
- **Show only if** accepts the same condition as `[[IF:...]]` inside the DOCX: any Questionnaire Field on this precedent, of any type. A Yes/No field gates on its actual answer; any other field type (Text, Number, Date, Select) gates on “did the requester fill this in.” An administrator can hide or show an entire section based on a field they themselves just added on the Questionnaire Fields tab — no developer required. A generator may also declare a small number of its own flags on top of this (for example the Will’s REPEAT-scoped `beneficiary.per_stirpes`) — those remain usable too, they are not the only option.
- It does not control a generator’s fixed opening wording — use an optional `front_matter` clause tag for that (see “Example 7: optional front matter override” above).

- Leaving Structure empty is not a stripped-down mode — it simply uses the generator’s own built-in default order, which is exactly what every precedent used before Structure existed.

Example: hide an entire section from a plain optional field, no developer involved

Goal: a “Special Instructions” section should only appear in the generated document when the requester actually entered something.

1. On **Questionnaire Fields**, add `special_instructions`, type Text (multi-line/Textarea works too), **Required off**.
2. In the DOCX, tag a clause: `[[CLAUSE:special_instructions_clause]] {{answers.special_instructions}} [[/CLAUSE]]`.
3. On **Structure**, select **Add section**, heading `Special Instructions`, Content source = Clause tag, Clause tag = `special_instructions_clause`, **Show only if** = `special_instructions`.
4. Save. Clause Marker Check confirms `special_instructions` is a recognised condition — it is, because every Questionnaire Field is automatically available here.
5. Generate one test request with the field left blank (section absent, numbering of later sections shifts up automatically) and one with text entered (section present, showing that exact text).

This is the general pattern for “give the client control over which sections appear”: add a plain Questionnaire Field for whatever decides it, tag the section’s wording as its own clause, and gate it on Structure — entirely inside the admin UI.

Formatting tab

The Formatting tab gives each precedent a consistent professional document style. Start with a profile, then adjust individual fields when the document has a specific filing or firm requirement. A field left blank falls back to the selected profile and then to the firm-wide default in System Settings → Document Defaults (see Section 13).

Profile	Recommended use	Starting style
Legal Traditional	Wills, powers of attorney, agreements, and general legal drafting	Times New Roman 12pt, justified, 1.15 line spacing, standard 25.4mm margins, bold headings, page numbers.
Legal Modern	Client-facing letters and contemporary firm documents	Arial 11pt, left aligned, 1.15 line spacing, standard margins, page numbers.
Court Filing	A starting point for documents requiring generous annotation/ binding space	Times New Roman 12pt, double spaced, 38.1mm left margin, standard other margins, page numbers. Always confirm current court rules before relying on this profile.
Custom	A document with approved firm-specific requirements	Keeps the individual values entered below; no profile defaults are imposed.

Changing the profile fills its recommended values into the form. Review those values before saving; individual fields can then be changed without creating a new profile.

Field	Effect
Font Family	Base font for generated text: Times New Roman, Arial, Calibri, Georgia, or Garamond.
Font Size (pt)	Base body text size, 8–24pt.
Body Alignment	Left, Justified, or Centred for generator-authored body paragraphs.
Line Spacing	Single, 1.15, 1.5, or Double for generator-authored body paragraphs.
After Paragraph (pt)	White space after each generator-authored paragraph. Use spacing rather than empty paragraphs.
First Line (mm)	Indents the first line of ordinary body and clause paragraphs. It is intentionally not added to list items.
Left/Right Indent (mm)	Insets body paragraphs and generated/imported list paragraphs from the page margins.
Apply paragraph style to uploaded clauses	When enabled, applies alignment, line spacing, paragraph spacing, and indentation to uploaded clause paragraphs and lists for uniform output. Inline bold, italic, font runs, tables, and list numbering remain preserved.
Heading Weight	Bold or Not bold for every generated heading in this document.
Heading Size Step (pt per level)	How many points larger each heading level is than the one below it — 0 makes every heading level the same size.
Top/Right/Bottom/Left Margin (mm)	Page margins for the complete generated document. Court and filing rules may require particular values.
Footer Text	Optional firm, matter, confidentiality, or document-control notice centred in the footer. Avoid unnecessary client-sensitive information.
Show page numbers	Adds Page X of Y at the bottom-right of every page.

Font, body alignment, line spacing, paragraph spacing, indentation, and heading controls always affect generator-authored content. Generated list items receive the body alignment, spacing, and left/right indentation without a first-line indent. When **Apply paragraph style to uploaded clauses** is enabled, the same paragraph layout is merged into clause paragraphs and lists; inline bold, italic, explicit font runs, tables, and numbering remain preserved. When it is disabled, clause

paragraph layout remains exactly as stored in the uploaded DOCX. Page margins, footer text, and page numbering apply to the complete generated document.

For a consistent result, format every uploaded clause with the same approved Word styles as the selected profile. A profile cannot overwrite deliberately preserved formatting inside a clause. After any formatting change, generate a realistic multi-page test and inspect both DOCX and PDF for headings stranded at page bottoms, list indentation, table width, footer collisions, page numbering, signature space, and compliance with current filing requirements.

Precedent quality assurance

Every saved precedent has two QA panels below its edit form: **Automated Test Scenarios** and **Quality Assurance Runs**. QA does not replace solicitor review. It provides repeatable technical evidence that markers resolve, expected wording is present or absent, and reviewers can see which configuration areas changed.

Add an automated test scenario

1. Save the precedent first, then open its Edit page.
2. Under **Automated Test Scenarios**, select **New automated test scenario**.
3. Enter a unique, descriptive name such as `No alternate executor – Public Trustee fallback`.
4. Enter **Answers** as a JSON object using the precedent's Questionnaire Field names, for example `{"testator_name":"Jane Doe","alternate_executor_name":null}`.
5. If needed, enter **Party rows** as a JSON object whose keys are Party Group keys and values are arrays of rows, for example `{"beneficiaries":[{"name":"Alex Doe","share":100,"gender":"male"}]}`.
6. Optionally enter the exact expected generated title.
7. Add short, distinctive phrases under **Output must include** and **Output must not include**. Test legal outcomes rather than generic words that could appear elsewhere.
8. Leave **Active** on and save.

Create paired scenarios for every conditional branch: Yes/No, value present/blank, one/many party rows, substitute/fallback paths, and boundary cases. Scenario execution occurs inside a rolled-back database transaction; it does not leave a real Document Request behind.

Worked example: Power of Attorney with two attorneys

Assume the saved precedent contains these technical names:

- Questionnaire Fields: `principal_name`, `principal_address`, `is_enduring`, and `attorneys_act_jointly`
- Party Group key: `attorneys`
- Attorney fields: `name` and `address`

The names must match the precedent configuration exactly, including underscores and singular/plural spelling. Labels such as **Principal's Full Name** are not valid JSON keys unless that exact text is also the configured technical name.

Create this scenario:

Scenario input	Example value
Name	Enduring POA – two attorneys acting jointly
Active	On
Expected title	Enter the exact title normally produced by this precedent, or leave blank if the title is not being tested

Paste the following into **Answers (JSON object)**:

```
{
  "principal_name": "Jane Example",
  "principal_address": "10 Example Street, Sydney NSW 2000",
  "is_enduring": true,
  "attorneys_act_jointly": true
}
```

Paste the following into **Party rows (JSON object)**:

```
{
  "attorneys": [
    {
      "name": "Alex Example",
      "address": "20 Sample Road, Sydney NSW 2000"
    },
    {
      "name": "Morgan Example",
      "address": "30 Test Avenue, Sydney NSW 2000"
    }
  ]
}
```

In **Output must include**, add each phrase as a separate tag by typing it and pressing Enter. Choose short phrases that uniquely prove the intended branch and parties were generated, for example:

- Jane Example
- Alex Example
- Morgan Example
- jointly
- a distinctive phrase from the enduring-authority clause

In **Output must not include**, add a phrase that belongs only to the opposite branch, for example a distinctive phrase used when attorneys act separately. Do not use broad words such as **not**, **document**, or **attorney**; they may legitimately occur elsewhere and cause a false failure.

Save the scenario, select **Run QA**, then scroll to **Quality Assurance Runs**. A passing result proves that this exact data set generated without an exception, produced the expected title if supplied, contained every include phrase, and contained none of the exclude phrases. It does not prove that the legal wording is correct; compare the generated wording with the approved precedent.

Paired example: test the opposite conditional branch

Duplicate the idea as a second scenario named **Non-enduring POA – attorneys acting separately**, but change the relevant Boolean answers:

```
{
  "principal_name": "Jane Example",
  "principal_address": "10 Example Street, Sydney NSW 2000",
  "is_enduring": false,
  "attorneys_act_jointly": false
}
```

Now reverse the branch-specific expectations: require a distinctive phrase from the non-enduring/separate-authority wording and exclude the phrase unique to the enduring/joint wording. Keep realistic Party rows. Testing only the **true** case does not prove the **false** branch works.

JSON and expectation checklist

- Use double quotes around JSON keys and text values; do not use Word-style curly quotation marks.
- Use **true** and **false** without quotes for Boolean fields, numbers without quotes for numeric fields, and **null** for an intentionally empty value.
- Use an empty object **{}** when the precedent has no party groups for that scenario. Do not paste comments into JSON.
- Include every field required by the precedent and every party field needed by its generator. A scenario does not automatically copy client data.
- Copy technical names from **Questionnaire Fields** and **Party Groups**; never guess them from the staff-facing label.
- Expected phrases are case-sensitive and must appear in the generated text exactly as entered.
- Use fictional QA data, not a real client's personal or matter information.
- After changing the template, fields, party groups, clauses, formatting, or scenarios, save and run QA again; the earlier run becomes stale.

Run and interpret QA

Select **Run QA** at the top of Precedent Edit. The saved report has one of three statuses:

- **Passed** — no technical validation errors/warnings and every active scenario passed.
- **Warning** — generation tests passed, but a non-blocking concern needs review (for example, no active scenarios or a required no-code field not referenced in template text).
- **Failed** — a blocking validation error or scenario failure occurred.

The validation report checks the private source DOCX exists, saved marker validation is clear, questionnaire and party-group keys are not duplicated, required no-code fields are referenced, and active scenarios exist. Each scenario reports title/include/exclude mismatches or the exact generation exception.

When QA finds a problem, the notification now shows up to the first three issue or failed-scenario details and remains visible until dismissed. Scroll to **Quality Assurance Runs**: the **Validation issues** column shows the issue count and the first issue message directly in the row. Select **View issues** for the complete report, including:

- **Validation issues** — severity, technical code, and the full explanation;
- **Scenario results** — each passed or failed scenario and its exact failed expectation or generation error; and
- **Changes from baseline** — the affected configuration area with its before and after values.

For example, `WARNING [no_scenarios] No active automated test scenarios are configured` means the precedent itself may still generate, but it has no repeatable test case. Add and activate at least one realistic scenario, save it, and run QA again. Do not treat the issue count alone as sufficient evidence; open the full report and resolve or formally assess every listed item.

Baseline comparison and stale results

After an approved review point, select **Set QA Baseline**. Future runs compare against that saved snapshot, including the source DOCX SHA-256 checksum, extracted template text, fields, party groups, structure, formatting, mapping, generator, jurisdiction, review settings, and test scenarios. The report displays before/after values for changed areas.

A QA run is marked **Stale** whenever the current precedent or scenario configuration no longer matches the fingerprint tested by that run. Run QA again after every change. Setting a baseline records a comparison reference; it does not approve or publish the precedent. This release provides structured and extracted-text comparison, not pixel-by-pixel PDF comparison, so reviewers must still inspect generated DOCX and PDF samples visually.

Questionnaire Fields tab

Questionnaire Fields create the single-value inputs that staff see on Step 2, **Details**, of a Document Request. Use them for facts that normally occur once per document: the principal's name, document date, address, a Yes/No instruction, or a fixed selection.

Do not use a Questionnaire Field for a list of people. Use a Party Group for attorneys, beneficiaries, guardians, or any other role that may have several rows.

Add a questionnaire field step by step

1. Select **Add field**.
2. Enter **Field name**. This is the permanent technical name used by the template and generator, for example `principal_name`.
3. Enter **Staff-facing label**, for example **Principal's Full Name**. This is what document-request users read.
4. Select **Input type**.

5. Set **Required** on when a request must not be submitted without a value.
6. For Select inputs, add each permitted stored value and displayed label under **Choices**.
7. Enter **Description (for reference)** explaining what the value means and how the generator uses it.
8. Collapse the item when complete, add further fields, and drag them into the order staff should complete them.
9. Save the precedent, create a test request, and confirm labels, order, validation, and choices.

Bulk import fields from CSV

Adding fields one at a time is fine for a handful of fields, but a new precedent with twenty or more fields is faster to set up from a spreadsheet. Select **Import Fields from CSV** at the top of the precedent edit screen.

1. Prepare a CSV with the header row `name,label,type,required,description,options`.
2. One row per field:
 - `name` — the technical field name (same rules as typing it by hand: lowercase, starts with a letter, letters/numbers/underscores only).
 - `label` — the staff-facing label.
 - `type` — one of `text`, `textarea`, `number`, `date`, `boolean`, `select`.
 - `required` — `yes/true/1` or `no/false/0`. Leave the column out of the CSV entirely to default every row to required, matching a new field's own default.
 - `description` — the reference note explaining the field.
 - `options` — only for `select` fields: pipe-separated `value=Label` pairs, for example `male=Male|female=Female`. Leave blank for any other type.
3. Upload the file and confirm.
4. LawDocs validates every row against the same rules as the on-screen form. A row that fails (bad name format, missing label/description, an unrecognised type) is skipped, not silently accepted — the confirmation notice lists exactly which rows were skipped and why. Fix the CSV and re-import to retry only the corrected rows.
5. A row whose `name` matches a field that already exists on this precedent updates that field in place rather than creating a duplicate; a genuinely new name is appended. If the same name appears twice within one CSV, the later row wins.
6. After import, the Questionnaire Fields list on screen updates immediately — check the order, labels, and choices, then save and test a request as usual.

CSV import is a faster way to fill in the same Questionnaire Fields tab described above — it does not create a different kind of field, and every field it creates is fully editable afterwards through the normal on-screen controls.

Choose the correct input type

Type	Use it for	Example
Text	One short line	Full name, suburb, reference wording

Type	Use it for	Example
Textarea	Several lines	Special instructions or a long address, only if the generator/template expects it
Number	Numeric value	Age or amount; use Party Group share fields for distributed percentages
Date	A calendar date	Date of birth
Yes / No	A true/false instruction	Enduring power? Attorneys act jointly?
Select	One value from a controlled list	Gender or another fixed legal option

For a Select field such as `principal_gender`, Choices may be:

Value saved by LawDocs	Label shown to staff
<code>male</code>	Male
<code>female</code>	Female

The stored value can be used by generator logic, so do not change it casually after production use. Labels may be clearer for staff, but changes still require testing.

Worked questionnaire example

Field name	Staff-facing label	Type	Required	Purpose
<code>principal_name</code>	Principal's Full Name	Text	Yes	Used in document title/opening text
<code>principal_dob</code>	Principal's Date of Birth	Date	No	Client record and age guidance
<code>principal_addresses</code>	Principal's Address	Text	Yes	Used in opening text
<code>is_enduring</code>	Enduring Power of Attorney?	Yes/No	Yes	Controls enduring wording
<code>attorneys_act_jointly</code>	Attorneys must act jointly?	Yes/No	Yes	Controls joint versus joint-and-several wording

In a DOCX clause, `principal_name` would be referenced as `{{answers.principal_name}}`. The screen label **Principal's Full Name** is never placed inside the braces.

Field-name rules and change control

- Begin with a lowercase letter.
- Use only lowercase letters, numbers, and underscores.
- Use a clear subject prefix: `principal_address` is safer than the vague `address`.
- Never include spaces, punctuation, apostrophes, or hyphens.
- Do not create two fields with the same name.
- Treat a saved field name like a database key, not editable display wording.

Renaming or deleting a field can break client mappings, DOCX placeholders, generator logic, tests, and regeneration of old requests. Before changing one, search every configuration/template reference, keep the precedent inactive, and repeat all test cases.

What Questionnaire Fields cannot do

The current screen creates an ordered list of inputs; it does not provide an administrator button for arbitrary visual subheadings or collapsible form sections within the Details step. If the goal is a dynamic **document** section, use the supported clause/IF method described under “Create a dynamic document section.” If the goal is a new custom **screen** section or new generator-controlled behaviour, developer work is required.

Client Mapping tab

Client Mapping connects a reusable Client record to the Questionnaire Fields of this specific precedent. It saves retyping and reduces spelling errors; it does not lock or verify the value.

The left side is fixed Client data: Full Name, DOB, Gender, Email, Phone, Street, Suburb, State, and Postcode. Each selector on the right lists the Questionnaire Fields already created for this precedent.

Configure client mapping step by step

1. Complete and save the Questionnaire Fields first.
2. Open **Client Mapping**.
3. For **Client’s Full Name**, choose the questionnaire field that means the same thing—for example `principal_name`.
4. For **Date of Birth**, choose `principal_dob`.
5. Continue only where there is a true semantic match.
6. Leave **Not mapped** for client values the document does not request.
7. Save the precedent.
8. Create or open a fictional client with known values.
9. Start a new Document Request, select that client and this precedent, and confirm the intended fields prefill.
10. Change the client selector and the precedent selector during testing; confirm the correct values are reapplied and recheck all answers.

Example mapping

Client attribute	Map to questionnaire field	Result on request
Client's Full Name	<code>principal_name</code>	Principal's Full Name prefills
Date of Birth	<code>principal_dob</code>	Principal's Date of Birth prefills
Street	<code>principal_street</code> if such a field exists	Street prefills separately
Email	Not mapped	Email remains unused by this request

Mapping Street to `principal_address` would copy only the street value, not automatically build a full address from Street, Suburb, State, and Postcode. Either create separate questionnaire fields and use them as designed, maintain a suitable complete-address field through approved changes, or have staff enter the full address manually. Do not map several Client attributes to one target in the hope that LawDocs will concatenate them.

Mapping safety rules

- Map like to like: name to name, DOB to DOB, gender to gender.
- Never map a client phone number into an address or document instruction field merely because both are Text inputs.
- Mapping is precedent-specific. `testator_name` may be correct for a Will, while `principal_name` is correct for a Power of Attorney.
- Empty client attributes do not overwrite a field with useful data, but staff must still review the request.
- Prefilled fields remain editable. A user can correct a changed address for the current request; update the Client record too when appropriate.
- Client Mapping does not import related people. Contacts are imported through Party Groups on the request screen.

Party Groups tab

Party Groups create repeatable sets of structured rows on the Document Request. Use a group whenever users may need to add one, two, or many people/items of the same role.

Examples are Beneficiaries, Attorneys, Guardians, or Executors. Each group can be repeated in the Word clause using `[[REPEAT:...]]`.

Add a party group step by step

1. Select **Add party group**.
2. Enter **Group key**, such as `attorneys`. This is the permanent technical plural name.
3. Enter **Staff-facing label**, such as **Attorneys**.
4. Select **Role type**: Beneficiary, Executor, Guardian, Attorney, or Custom.

5. Enter **Min rows**. Use 1 when at least one party is mandatory; use 0 only when the entire group is optional.
6. Enter **Max rows**, or leave blank for no application maximum.
7. If percentage distribution applies, enter **Share field name** matching one row field, such as `share`.
8. Enable **Supports substitute** only when rows can designate a specific fallback.
9. Enable **Supports per-stirpes** only when that concept is appropriate and supported by the generator/template.
10. Under **Fields captured per row**, add the data required for one party.
11. Save and test minimum/maximum rows, contact import, row ordering, validation, and generated repetition.

Example: Attorneys group

Group-level settings:

Setting	Value
Group key	<code>attorneys</code>
Label	Attorneys
Role type	Attorney
Min rows	1
Max rows	blank
Share field	blank
Supports substitute	Off
Supports per-stirpes	Off

Row fields:

Field name	Row-facing label	Type	Required
<code>name</code>	Attorney's Full Name	Text	Yes
<code>address</code>	Attorney's Address	Text	Yes
<code>relationship</code>	Relationship to Principal	Text	No

The DOCX connection is:

```
[[REPEAT:attorneys AS attorney]]
I appoint {{attorney.name}} of {{attorney.address}} to be my Attorney.
[[/REPEAT]]
```

If staff enter three attorney rows, the sentence is generated three times in the displayed row order.

Example: Beneficiaries group with shares

Configure group key `beneficiaries`, label Beneficiaries, minimum 1, and Share field `share`. Add row fields `name`, `share`, and `gender`. Enable per-stirpes only when the Will generator/template supports it.

Beneficiary row	name	share	per_stirpes
1	David Sullivan	60	Yes
2	Emily Sullivan	40	No

Because Share field is `share`, the application requires all rows to total exactly 100. The per-stirpes toggle is automatically added to each row when support is enabled; do not also create a manual field named `per_stirpes`.

Bulk import row fields from CSV

Row fields within a party group can be bulk-imported the same way Questionnaire Fields can (see “Bulk import fields from CSV” above), using **Import Party Group Fields from CSV** at the top of the precedent edit screen. The one difference is an extra required column, `group_key`, identifying which existing party group each row belongs to.

1. Create the party group itself first, on this tab, with its key, label, and role settings — the CSV only fills in a group’s **row fields**, it does not create the group.
2. Prepare a CSV with the header row
`group_key,name,label,type,required,description,options`.
3. `group_key` must exactly match an existing group’s key on this precedent, for example `attorneys`. A row whose `group_key` does not match any existing group is skipped, with the reason given in the confirmation notice — it is not used to create a new group.
4. The remaining columns (`name`, `label`, `type`, `required`, `description`, `options`) follow the same rules as the Questionnaire Fields CSV import.
5. One CSV can define row fields for several different groups at once — each row’s `group_key` routes it to the correct group. A row whose `name` matches a field already present in that same group updates it in place; a new name is appended to that group’s field list. Fields in a group not mentioned in the CSV are left untouched.

Party field and contact-import design

Contacts are imported by matching standard field names. Fields such as `name`, `relationship`, `gender`, `email`, `phone`, `address`, `street`, `suburb`, `state`, `postcode`, and `dob` can receive matching saved contact data. A custom name such as `attorney_full_legal_name` will not automatically match the contact’s standard `name` value.

Imported rows remain editable. Fields with no matching Client Contact value—such as `share`—remain blank and must be completed.

Party Group safety rules

- Group keys are plural and stable; aliases in Word are normally singular.
- Row field names use lowercase letters, numbers, and underscores only.
- The Share field setting must exactly match an existing numeric row field.
- Minimum/maximum values control the request UI; they do not decide substantive legal suitability.
- Row order is persisted and can affect generated wording.
- Avoid duplicate primary names when using Specific Substitute because name matching may be ambiguous.
- Do not enable substitute/per-stirpes controls unless the selected generator and approved clause wording consume them.
- Changing a group key or field name requires updating every REPEAT, alias placeholder, generator expectation, and test.

Create a dynamic document section

“Dynamic section” can mean three different things in LawDocs:

Desired result	Configuration to use
Add a new input dynamically to the request Details step	Add a Questionnaire Field
Add a repeatable block of people/items to the request	Add a Party Group
Include, exclude, or repeat wording in the generated document	Use a supported named CLAUSE with IF and/or REPEAT markers

There is no generic **Add Dynamic Section** button, but the named clauses/wording inside one are almost entirely admin-controlled. Every Questionnaire Field on the precedent — of any type, not just Yes/No — is automatically a valid `[[IF:...]]` condition: a Yes/No field evaluates as its actual answer, and any other field type (Text, Number, Date, Select) evaluates as **true when the requester filled it in, false when left blank**. This is why Example E below works with no developer involvement at all — an optional field becomes a switch just by existing. A generator can still declare a handful of its own flags on top of this (shown in the on-screen reference next to the file upload), which win if a name collides, but for the common case of “show this paragraph only if the requester answered/entered something,” a plain Questionnaire Field is all that is needed.

The only case that genuinely needs a developer is a document type requiring computed logic that cannot be expressed as a plain condition or repeat — see “Choosing a generator” below for how the no-code **Template** generator covers everything short of that.

Choosing a generator: Template vs. a specialist generator

Generator	When to use it	What it can express without a developer
Template	Any new document type that is built entirely from clauses, placeholders, and repeatable party rows — the default choice for a brand-new precedent	Everything on this page: verbatim clauses, <code>[[IF:...]] / [[ELSE]]</code> on any Questionnaire Field, <code>[[REPEAT:...]]</code> over any configured Party Group, <code>{{answers.field}}</code> placeholders, and auto-computed pronouns (Example F)
Will / Power of Attorney / Enduring Guardianship / Costs Agreement	The document needs a specific piece of computed wording these generators already provide (for example, the Will's executor/alternate-executor/Public Trustee appointment chain), or the firm is deliberately reusing one of the maintained starter precedents	The same marker features as Template, plus that generator's own hand-written computed paragraph(s)

Selecting **Template** as the Document Generator, then tagging every needed `[[CLAUSE:...]]` in the uploaded DOCX, is the fastest path from “the firm needs a new document type” to an activated precedent with no code changes at all — see “Complete worked configuration: a fully dynamic precedent with the Template generator” later in this section for a full walkthrough.

Example A: dynamic Yes/No document section using an existing flag

Goal: show an Enduring Power Notice only when the user answers Yes to **Enduring Power of Attorney?**

1. **Questionnaire Fields:** create `is_enduring`, label **Enduring Power of Attorney?**, type Yes/No, Required on.
2. **Generator:** select Power of Attorney. Its on-screen reference lists `is_enduring` as an allowed IF condition. The required-clause table in this manual confirms that this generator uses `enduring_notice` (custom generators require developer documentation).
3. **Template File:** enter:

```
[[CLAUSE:enduring_notice]]
[[IF:is_enduring]]
Approved enduring notice wording goes here.
[[/IF]]
[[/CLAUSE]]
```

1. Test request 1 with Yes: the section wording must appear.
2. Test request 2 with No: the wording must be absent; check that an unwanted blank paragraph/page is not created.

This is dynamic because a request answer controls whether the clause has visible content.

Example B: dynamic alternative wording using IF/ELSE

Goal: choose joint or joint-and-several wording.

1. Create Questionnaire Field `attorneys_act_jointly`, type Yes/No, Required on.
2. Confirm Power of Attorney lists it as an allowed flag.
3. Inside `appointment_clause`, add:

```
[[IF:attorneys_act_jointly]]
Approved wording for attorneys who must act jointly.
[[ELSE]]
Approved wording for attorneys who may act jointly and severally.
[[/IF]]
```

1. Generate one Yes and one No test and compare both outputs with approved wording.

Example C: dynamic repeated section using a Party Group

Goal: generate one appointment paragraph for every attorney.

1. Create Party Group key `attorneys` with fields `name`, `address`, and `relationship`.
2. Confirm the Power of Attorney generator lists `attorneys` as an allowed group.
3. Put this inside `appointment_clause`:

```
[[REPEAT:attorneys AS attorney]]
I appoint {{attorney.name}} of {{attorney.address}} to be my Attorney.
[[/REPEAT]]
```

1. Test zero rows (the request should be blocked when Min rows is 1), one row, and several rows.
2. Confirm the output count and order exactly match the request rows.

Example D: request input dynamically prefilled from a client

Goal: prefill Principal's Full Name without retyping.

1. Create Questionnaire Field `principal_name`.
2. In Client Mapping, map Client's Full Name to `principal_name`.
3. In the request wizard, select a saved Client and the configured precedent.
4. Confirm Principal's Full Name is prefilled but still editable.
5. The generator can use the answer directly, and a marked clause can reference it as `{{answers.principal_name}}` where supported.

Example E: conditional wording driven by an optional field, no Yes/No toggle needed

Goal: name an alternate executor only when the requester actually supplies one — without adding a separate Yes/No field just to ask “is there an alternate?”

1. Create Questionnaire Field `alternate_executor_name`, type Text, **Required off**.
2. Inside the relevant clause, add:

```
[[IF:alternate_executor_name]]
If the primary executor cannot act, I appoint {{answers.alternate_executor_name}} as my
executor.
[[ELSE]]
If the primary executor cannot act, I appoint the Public Trustee as my executor.
[[/IF]]
```

1. Test one request leaving Alternate Executor Name blank: confirm the Public Trustee wording appears.
2. Test a second request with a name entered: confirm that exact name appears and the Public Trustee wording does not.

This works because any Questionnaire Field — not only Yes/No fields — is a valid `[[IF:...]]` condition: text, number, date, and select fields all evaluate as true once the requester has entered something, false while blank.

Example F: automatic pronoun agreement from a Gender field

Goal: say “he”/“she” correctly for a named person without a generator computing it in PHP.

1. Create Questionnaire Field named exactly `executor_gender` (any field name ending in `_gender`), type Select, options Male/Female, Required on.
2. Anywhere in the same clause, reference `{{answers.executor_gender_pronoun_subject}}`, `..._pronoun_object}}`, `..._pronoun_possessive}}`, or `..._pronoun_reflexive}}` — for example:

```
I appoint {{answers.executor_name}} as my executor. If
{{answers.executor_gender_pronoun_subject}} is unable to act, I appoint the Public Trustee.
```

1. Generate one test request with Male selected and one with Female selected; confirm “he”/“his”/“himself” versus “she”/“her”/“herself” appear correctly, with no developer writing any pronoun logic.

The four pronoun placeholders only exist when the underlying `_gender` field actually has a value — reference one unconditionally only on a field marked Required, or wrap the reference in `[[IF:...]]` if the field is optional, the same way Example E gates `alternate_executor_name`.

Dynamic-section verification matrix

For every dynamic section, document and test:

Test question	Evidence required
What field/group controls it?	Exact technical name recorded
Does the selected generator support it?	Name visible in generator reference or developer confirmation
What happens when true/filled?	Expected paragraph(s) visible
What happens when false/blank?	Expected alternative or no section; no stray heading/page
What happens with one/many rows?	Correct count, order, numbering, and grammar
Does client mapping prefill correctly?	Test client produces expected editable values
Are DOCX and PDF both correct?	Visual sign-off for all branches

Complete worked configuration: Power of Attorney

This example shows how all tabs connect.

1. **Details:** Title = Power of Attorney; Category = power of attorney; Jurisdiction = NSW; Generator = Power of Attorney; Requires review = On; Active = Off during setup.
2. **Questionnaire Fields:** add `principal_name` (Text, required), `principal_dob` (Date, optional), `principal_address` (Text, required), `is_enduring` (Yes/No, required), and `attorneys_act_jointly` (Yes/No, required).
3. **Client Mapping:** map Client Full Name to `principal_name` and Date of Birth to `principal_dob`. Other attributes may remain unmapped unless equivalent questionnaire fields exist.
4. **Party Groups:** key `attorneys`, label Attorneys, role Attorney, minimum 1; add fields `name` (required Text), `address` (required Text), and `relationship` (optional Text).
5. **Template File:** provide exactly named clauses expected by the generator—`appointment_clause`, `enduring_notice`, `general_powers`, and `revocation`. Inside `appointment_clause`, repeat `attorneys AS attorney` and use `{{attorney.name}}` / `{{attorney.address}}`. Use the supported `attorneys_act_jointly` IF/ELSE. Inside `enduring_notice`, use `[[IF:is_enduring]]`.
6. Save, inspect Clause Marker Check and extracted preview, then generate test cases for one attorney/Yes enduring, two attorneys/No enduring, jointly Yes, and jointly No.
7. Confirm output and approval before switching Active on.

The safest design sequence is **generator → questionnaire fields → party groups → client mapping → DOCX markers → test requests → approval → activation**. Changing a technical key later requires checking every downstream reference.

Complete worked configuration: a fully dynamic precedent with the Template generator, then generating documents from it

This walkthrough builds a brand-new document type — a Client Engagement Letter — from nothing, using only the no-code **Template** generator and every feature covered in this manual:

bulk CSV import for both Questionnaire Fields and Party Group row fields, conditional wording on an optional field, automatic pronoun agreement, a repeated section, Structure, and Formatting. It then generates documents from the finished precedent both one at a time and in a batch. No developer involvement is required anywhere in this walkthrough.

Step 1 — Details tab. Title = **Client Engagement Letter**; Category = your firm's choice; Jurisdiction = NSW; **Document Generator = Template**; Requires review = On; Active = Off during setup.

Step 2 — Questionnaire Fields, via CSV bulk import. Select **Import Fields from CSV** and upload a file with this content:

```
name,label,type,required,description,options
client_name,Client's Full Name,text,yes,The person or entity engaging the firm,
client_gender,Client's Gender,select,yes,Used for pronoun agreement,male=Male|female=Female
engagement_date,Engagement Date,date,yes,When the retainer begins,
has_conflict_check,Conflict Check Completed?,boolean,yes,Confirms a conflict check was run
before engagement,
referral_source,Referred By (optional),text,no,Leave blank if the client approached the firm
directly,
```

This creates five fields in one pass, covering every input type this manual documents: text, select, date, Yes/No, and an optional text field. `client_gender` and `referral_source` are deliberately named/typed to be reused in Step 5 for automatic pronouns and conditional wording.

Step 3 — Party Groups. On the Party Groups tab, create a group manually first — key `matter_contacts`, label **Additional Contacts**, minimum rows 0 (this group is optional; not every matter has extra contacts). Then select **Import Party Group Fields from CSV** and upload:

```
group_key,name,label,type,required,description,options
matter_contacts,name,Contact Name,text,yes,,
matter_contacts,email,Email Address,text,yes,,
```

The group must exist before the CSV import — the import only fills in a group's row fields, it never creates the group itself.

Step 4 — Client Mapping. Map Client's Full Name to `client_name`.

Step 5 — Template File. Upload a DOCX tagging these clauses, each demonstrating a different feature from this section:

```

[[CLAUSE:front_matter]]
This engagement letter is between the firm and {{answers.client_name}}, dated
{{answers.engagement_date}}.
[[/CLAUSE]]

[[CLAUSE:referral_note]]
[[IF:referral_source]]
We note this engagement was referred by {{answers.referral_source}}.
[[/IF]]
[[/CLAUSE]]

[[CLAUSE:conflict_statement]]
[[IF:has_conflict_check]]
A conflict check has been completed and no conflict was identified.
[[ELSE]]
A conflict check is still pending and will be completed before work commences.
[[/IF]]
[[/CLAUSE]]

[[CLAUSE:pronoun_note]]
If {{answers.client_gender_pronoun_subject}} requires any changes to these terms, please
contact us in writing.
[[/CLAUSE]]

[[CLAUSE:contacts_clause]]
[[REPEAT:matter_contacts AS contact]]
Copy correspondence to {{contact.name}} ({{contact.email}}).
[[/REPEAT]]
[[/CLAUSE]]

```

`referral_note` uses `[[IF:referral_source]]` — a plain optional Text field, not a Yes/No — exactly as in Example E. `conflict_statement` uses a real Yes/No field with `[[ELSE]]`. `pronoun_note` uses the automatic pronoun placeholder from Example F: because `client_gender` is Required, referencing `{{answers.client_gender_pronoun_subject}}` unconditionally is safe. `contacts_clause` repeats once per row in the optional `matter_contacts` group and simply produces nothing when a request has none.

Step 6 — Structure tab. Add and order the non-front-matter sections: Referral Note, Conflict Statement, Contact, Additional Contacts — matching `referral_note`, `conflict_statement`, `pronoun_note`, and `contacts_clause` respectively.

Step 7 — Formatting tab. Select **Legal Modern** for this client-facing letter, or the firm’s approved profile. Review font, alignment, line and paragraph spacing, margins, footer, and page numbering. Generate a multi-page test rather than judging formatting from the flattened Extracted Text preview.

Step 8 — Save and verify. Inspect **Clause Marker Check** — it must be clear. Open the **Available flags, party groups & computed blocks** reference next to the file upload: it now lists every Questionnaire Field (not only the Yes/No one) as a usable `[[IF:...]]` target, confirming Step 5’s fields all resolve correctly, plus `matter_contacts` as a usable `[[REPEAT:...]]` group.

Step 9 — Test, then activate. Generate at least four test requests: referral source blank vs. filled, conflict check Yes vs. No, one request with zero additional contacts and one with two. Confirm every branch and the repeated section behave as expected, then switch Active on.

Now generate documents from the finished precedent

A single document, with preview. Open **New Document Request**, select the Client Engagement Letter precedent, and fill in Details. Before submitting, select **Preview Document (PDF)** at the top of the page as many times as needed — it renders the form’s current answers exactly as they stand, with no document request actually created, so you can check the referral/conflict/pronoun wording before committing. When satisfied, select **Create**. If the precedent requires review, open the resulting request and select **Preview (PDF)** to read the completed draft before approving — this is available immediately, it does not wait for approval — then **Approve for Download** and download.

Many documents at once, from a spreadsheet. From the Document Requests list, select **Download Batch CSV Template** and choose the Client Engagement Letter precedent. The downloaded file’s header row already matches this precedent’s exact fields and party-group columns:

```
case_reference,client_id,client_name,client_gender,engagement_date,has_conflict_check,referral_source,matter_contacts.1.name,matter_contacts.1.email,matter_contacts.2.name,matter_contacts.2.email
```

Party-group columns follow the pattern `group_key.slot.field` — `matter_contacts.1.name/` `matter_contacts.1.email` is the first additional contact on that row’s document, `matter_contacts.2.*` the second, and so on; leave a slot’s columns entirely blank to produce a document with fewer contacts than the template has columns for. Fill in one row per document — for example:

```
case_reference,client_id,client_name,client_gender,engagement_date,has_conflict_check,referral_source,matter_contacts.1.name,matter_contacts.1.email,matter_contacts.2.name,matter_contacts.2.email
MATTER-101,,Priya Anand,female,2026-08-20,yes,,Tom Whitfield,tom@example.com,,
MATTER-102,,Susan Wild,female,2026-08-21,no,Referred by Ashley Dewell,,,,
```

Select **Batch Generate from CSV**, choose the same precedent, and upload the file. The first screen validates every row and shows **“N will be generated, M skipped”** with the reason for each skipped row — nothing is created yet. Review the count, then select **Confirm & Generate**. Each valid row becomes its own trackable Document Request, visible and downloadable individually from the list exactly like a request created through the wizard. A single batch file is capped at 200 rows; split a larger spreadsheet into multiple uploads.

11. User administration (super administrator)

Screen: Users list / New User / Edit User

1. Select **New User**.
2. Enter Name, unique valid Email, Password (minimum eight characters), and Confirm Password.
3. Assign one or more roles. Avoid granting `super_admin` unless full control is required.
4. Under **Precedent Access**, optionally restrict an operator to categories. A blank selection means unrestricted; it does not mean no access.
5. Select **Create**.

When editing, leave Password blank to retain it. The list can be searched, sorted, filtered by role, and displays verification status. Deleting an account is consequential; preserve required request/audit ownership under firm policy before deletion.

12. Audit Log (administrator)

Purpose, access, and integrity

Open **Administration → Audit Log**. It is a chronological, read-only record used to investigate record changes, access-control changes, authentication activity, and document-file activity. It is visible only to users granted Audit Log view permissions—normally super administrators.

Audit entries cannot be created, edited, or deleted from this screen. This protects the value of the trail. The log supports operational investigation and accountability, but it is not automatically proof of legal compliance and does not replace the firm's formal monitoring, retention, or incident-response processes.

Screen: Audit Log list

The newest entry appears first. Columns are:

Column	Meaning
When	Server-recorded date and time to the second
Area	Activity category, such as <code>auth</code> , <code>access_control</code> , <code>document</code> , <code>client</code> , <code>precedent</code> , or <code>document_request</code>
Activity	Human-readable description, such as User logged in or a model was updated
By	User who caused the event; System when no authenticated actor is associated

Column	Meaning
On	Type of affected record, such as Client, Document, User, or DocumentRequest
Event	Created, Updated, Deleted, or another activity type

Use search for words in **Activity**. Sort by When/Area where offered, or use filters:

- **Area** — show one activity category.
- **Event** — Created, Updated, or Deleted.
- **From / Until** — inclusive calendar-date range.

Find an event step by step

Example: determine who changed a precedent during a known week.

1. Expand **Administration** and open **Audit Log**.
2. Open Filters.
3. Set **Area** to `precedent`.
4. Set **Event** to Updated.
5. Set **From** and **Until** to the investigation dates.
6. Apply the filters.
7. Review When, Activity, By, and On.
8. Select **View** on the relevant row for exact details.
9. Record the audit entry URL/identifier and findings according to firm procedure; do not alter business records merely to make the log look cleaner.

Clear or reset filters before starting a different investigation. An empty result may mean the filters are too narrow, the event is outside retention, activity logging was unavailable/disabled, or the action is not among the instrumented events.

Screen: View Audit Log Entry

The **Activity** section displays:

- **When** — exact recorded timestamp;
- **Area** — source category;
- **Activity** — event description;
- **Performed by** — actor or System;
- **On** — affected model and numeric record ID, for example `Client #24`;
- **IP address** — when the event captured a request IP.

The **Changed values** section appears when attribute changes were recorded:

- **Before** shows old stored values.
- **After** shows new stored values.

The **Other properties** section appears for additional context, such as assigned role/permission names, authentication guard, or email entered during a failed login.

Interpret common audit areas

Area/event	What it normally records	Example investigation use
<code>auth</code>	Successful login, logout, failed login; IP and guard where captured	Review suspicious sign-in attempts
<code>access_control</code>	Roles or permissions assigned/removed	Confirm who granted elevated access
<code>user</code>	Staff-account field changes	Review account/profile administration
<code>client</code> / related records	Client/contact creation and changes	Identify who corrected personal data
<code>precedent</code>	Template configuration changes	Trace a field, generator, or activation change
<code>document_request</code> / parties/witnesses	Request lifecycle and related-record changes	Reconstruct approval/signing-data activity
<code>document</code>	File Manager record creation, rename/move/path changes, copy creation, deletion	Trace working-file management
<code>setting</code>	System-setting changes	Review security, branding, mail, or generation settings

Area names reflect the underlying activity configuration and can differ after custom development.

Before-and-after example

An Updated precedent entry might show:

Before	After	Interpretation
<code>is_active: false</code>	<code>is_active: true</code>	The precedent was activated
<code>requires_review: true</code>	<code>requires_review: false</code>	Approval gate was disabled; investigate authorisation

Read the complete entry, actor, timestamp, and related operational context. A changed value says what was stored before/after; it does not explain the person's intention.

Authentication and access review

For a suspected account incident:

1. Filter **Area** to `auth` and set the date range.
2. Inspect successful and failed login activity, actors/emails, and IP addresses.
3. Filter **Area** to `access_control` for role/permission changes around the same time.
4. Review `user` entries for account changes.
5. Follow the firm's incident-response process. Preserve evidence and escalate; do not delete the user or related records impulsively.

An IP address identifies a network endpoint, not necessarily an individual. Shared networks, proxies, VPNs, and mobile carriers require careful interpretation.

Audit Log limitations and safe handling

- “System” means no user was associated with that entry; it does not automatically mean a scheduled task.
- The trail covers configured model and event activity, not every mouse click or document view.
- Audit data may contain personal, security, and changed-value information. Restrict access and exports/screenshots.
- Times use the application's displayed/server convention; account for timezone when comparing external evidence.
- Retention depends on system configuration and operational maintenance.
- If an expected entry is missing, do not conclude the action did not occur. Escalate with the affected record, approximate time, user, and expected action.
- Never share audit details through an unapproved channel.

13. System Settings (super administrator)

Select **System Settings**, change one or more tabs, then select **Save**. Appearance changes normally require a refresh.

General

- **Application Name** — header/login brand name.
- **Tagline** — login-page supporting text.

Appearance

- Color themes: Indigo, Amber Gold, Emerald, Rose, Violet, Sky Blue, Teal, Orange, Slate, Gray, Blue, Cyan, Purple, Pink.
- Panel modes: Light, Dark, System, High Contrast, Sepia, Midnight.
- Branding: Application Logo, App Icon/Favicon, and alternative Favicon. The alternative Favicon overrides the App Icon for browser tabs.

Document Defaults

- Set generated DOCX font family and size (8–24 pt).
- **Generate documents in the background** must be enabled only when a continuously supervised queue worker is operating. Otherwise requests remain Pending indefinitely. A standard deployment provisions this worker automatically (a systemd service restarted on every deploy) — check with an administrator that it is running before turning this on. Batch CSV generation always runs synchronously regardless of this setting.

Security

- **Allow two-factor authentication** is the firm-wide master switch. Individual users enroll through Profile.

Email

- Configure From Name, From Address, and optional Staff Notification Email for generation-failure alerts.
- Enter SMTP Host, Port, Username, Password, and TLS/SSL only for an approved mail provider. A blank host keeps the default non-delivery/log-style configuration.

Glossary

Term	Meaning in LawDocs
Active precedent	A precedent enabled for authorised users to select in the request wizard. Active does not mean solicitor-approved unless the firm's approval process says so.
Alias	The short name assigned after AS in a repeat marker, used to reference fields on the current party row, such as attorney.name .
Approval	A recorded human decision that a completed draft may be downloaded when the precedent requires review. It is not an automated legal check.
Audit Log	Read-only history of configured record, access-control, authentication, and file events. It is not a recording of every screen view or mouse click.
Baseline	A saved QA comparison reference containing the precedent configuration, scenario set, extracted template text, and source-file checksum at an approved review point.
Batch generation	Creation of several independent Document Requests from a precedent-specific CSV file after validation and confirmation.
Clause marker	Bracketed instruction in the source DOCX, such as [[CLAUSE:revocation]] , used to identify or control template content.
Client mapping	Precedent-specific connection that copies selected Client attributes into matching questionnaire answers when a client and precedent are selected.
Completed	Generation finished successfully. It does not mean the content is correct, reviewed, signed, or approved.
Computed block	Generator-provided content referenced by a Structure entry rather than a named clause extracted from the DOCX. Availability depends on the selected generator.
Conditional flag	A named true/false value used by IF / ELSE logic. It may come from an answer, presence of an optional value, or a specialist generator.
Document Request	The permanent record of one generation attempt, including precedent/client links, submitted answer snapshot, party rows, status, output, and review/signature tracking.

Term	Meaning in LawDocs
Executed copy	The signed document file uploaded after external signing. Uploading it records storage; LawDocs does not create or verify signatures.
Expected include/exclude	Case-sensitive phrases an automated scenario requires to be present or absent in the generated text.
Generator	The component that converts a request and precedent into structured draft content. Template is no-code; specialist generators may add document-specific logic.
Matter reference	Optional firm filing identifier saved on a request. It is distinct from the internal request ID.
Party Group	A repeatable collection of structured rows, such as attorneys, beneficiaries, guardians, or executors.
Placeholder	A token inside template content, such as <code>{{answers.principal_name}}</code> or <code>{{attorney.name}}</code> , replaced with request data during generation.
Precedent	The versioned configuration used to assemble a document: source DOCX, generator, clauses/structure, formatting, fields, mapping, parties, review rule, and tests.
Questionnaire Field	A named single-value input shown on the request Details step. Its technical name is used by mappings, placeholders, flags, CSVs, and automated scenarios.
QA run	A saved technical validation and execution of all active automated scenarios against the currently saved precedent.
Regenerate	Creation of a new request based on an existing request so corrections can be made without overwriting the original history.
Repeat marker	A template instruction that renders its contained elements once for every row in a Party Group.
Scenario	A saved fictional input set with optional title and include/exclude expectations used for repeatable precedent testing.
Snapshot	Preserved data as it existed for a particular record or event, such as answers submitted for a request or configuration captured by QA.

Term	Meaning in LawDocs
Stale QA run	A prior QA result whose fingerprint no longer matches the current saved precedent or scenario configuration. It must not be relied upon as current evidence.
Structure	Ordered list deciding which extracted clauses or computed blocks enter the generated document and under which conditions.
Technical name/key	Stable machine-readable identifier such as <code>principal_name</code> or <code>attorneys</code> ; it is different from the staff-facing label and should not be casually renamed.
Template generator	The no-code generator that assembles uploaded clause content using Structure, questionnaire answers, party groups, conditions, and formatting configuration.
Template/source DOCX	Private Word file uploaded to a precedent. It supplies extractable clause content and formatting; it is not itself the completed client document.
Witness tracking	Record of intended witnesses and signing status. It does not verify identity, capacity, independence, witnessing compliance, or a signature.

14. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Action
A precedent is absent from the wizard	Inactive, invalid, deleted, category-restricted, or not permitted	Ask a precedent administrator to verify Active status, validation, category, and your role.
Client data did not prefill	No client selected or no client-field mapping on that precedent	Select both client and precedent; enter manually or ask an operator to configure mapping.
Contact import is absent	No selected client, no saved contacts, or no party group	Save contacts against the client and reopen/reselect as needed.
Beneficiaries will not submit	Share field does not total exactly 100	Correct every row, including blank/decimal values, to total 100.
Request remains Pending	Background processing enabled without a working queue worker	Do not create duplicates; notify the administrator.
Status is Failed	Template marker, placeholder, file, or generation problem	Open View, copy the Error message, notify an operator, then Regenerate after correction.
Download buttons are missing	Not Completed, approval still required, insufficient permission; PDF converter may be unavailable	Check Status and Approval; request approval. Use DOCX if only PDF is unavailable.
Cannot add a witness	Witness name matches a recorded document party	Confirm independence and spelling; do not bypass the control without legal review.
Branding image does not appear	Public storage link/configuration issue	Administrator should verify storage publication; do not repeatedly upload duplicates.
Formatting looks inconsistent	Uploaded clause paragraph styling is being preserved while generated text uses the selected profile	Enable Apply paragraph style to uploaded clauses , or apply the firm's approved styles inside the source DOCX; then test both DOCX and PDF.
Footer or page number overlaps content	Bottom margin/footer content is too small/long for the output	Shorten the footer or increase the bottom margin, then regenerate a multi-page test.
QA run is Stale	The precedent template/configuration or its test scenarios changed after that run	Review the changes and run QA again; do not rely on the old result.

Symptom	Likely cause	Action
Automated scenario fails	Expected title/text does not match, answers/party JSON is incomplete, or generation raised an error	Open View Report, correct the precedent or scenario expectation, and rerun QA.
2FA code fails	Device time drift, wrong account, expired code, or used recovery code	Wait for a fresh code, check automatic time, or use one unused recovery code.

When escalating, provide the case reference, request ID/URL, status, exact error text, approximate time, and the action attempted. Do not email client data or documents through unapproved channels.

15. Data and audit notes

LawDocs stores staff accounts and roles; client identity/contact/address/notes; reusable client contacts; precedents and private DOCX templates; questionnaire and party-group configuration; requests, answer snapshots and party rows; generated DOCX paths; approvals; signature timestamps; witnesses; optional signed-document files; per-user File Manager folders/files and metadata; and read-only audit activity with actors, subjects, changed values, and selected request properties such as IP addresses. Templates, generated documents, executed copies, and File Manager content use private application storage; avatars and branding use public storage.

The repository includes starter precedents and demonstration clients, users, and request states in its default seed process. These records exist only to demonstrate the workflow. Demo credentials must be changed or removed before public production access, and bundled precedent wording must never be treated as solicitor-approved merely because it was installed by the seeder.

Follow the firm's retention, access-control, privacy, backup, and breach-response policies. Use least-privilege roles, keep 2FA enabled, avoid unnecessary personal data in Notes, and never treat deleting a UI record as proof that all backups or historical files have been erased.

16. Daily operating checklist

Requesting staff

1. Confirm client identity, jurisdiction, document type, and instructions.
2. Update the Client and Contacts records.
3. Create the request; review every prefilled value.
4. Complete required fields and party rows; verify shares/order/substitutions.
5. Add a case reference and submit once.
6. Monitor status and resolve failures without duplicating requests.
7. Review the generated draft and obtain approval where required.
8. Download through LawDocs and follow controlled signing procedures.

9. Record sent/signed timestamps, witnesses, and executed copy.

Reviewing staff

1. Work from **Awaiting Review**.
2. Compare submitted answers, precedent/jurisdiction, party details, and output.
3. Correct through Regenerate; do not silently edit away an audit trail.
4. Approve only after the firm's complete review procedure.

Administrators

1. Review failed and long-pending requests.
2. Maintain least-privilege users and category restrictions.
3. Validate and test precedent changes before activation.
4. Monitor queue, office/PDF conversion, email, private storage, backups, and access logs according to deployment policy.

Document control: This manual describes the application code and bundled data as inspected on 15 August 2026. Screen labels may change after future releases or local configuration. Firm procedure and current legal advice take precedence over this operational guide.